XFORMATIONDAN

NEW LIFE CAN GROW AT ANY TIME FROM DEATH

TRANSFORM YOUR LIFE BY TAKING CONTROL OF YOUR HEALTH

DAN HENSLEY

Xformation

Take control of your life by taking control of your health!

Warning

The advice advised in this book, although based on the author's experience with many thousands of clients, is not meant to be a replacement for the guidance and direction of your personal doctor. Please, consult your doctor before making any drastic dietary modifications.

If you are at the moment prescribed or taking diuretics, insulin or oral diabetes medications, please talk with your doctor before beginning Xformation. Individuals with severe kidney disease should not do Xformation. The weight loss stages of the Xformation Permanent Weight loss solutions are not appropriate for pregnant women and

nursing mothers.

Terms: LBM (Lean body mass) - This book uses pounds as the default. All macros are in grams.

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People who supported me

To my loving and lovely girlfriend Gabby, who has always blessed me with emotional, mental, and spiritual support. To my loving mom who helped me every step of the way. To my awesome brother Gary who has always had my back. And my lovely sisters, Sonya and Angie, whom I love dearly. To the rest of my family and friends who encouraged me and was supportive during my journey. And to my father who passed away Dec. 4th, 2010, he was always there for me, and without him, this book would not be possible.

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The Goal of Xformation

I wrote this book to raise awareness of health through weight loss. Achieving the body you desire is not impossible. Why are you reading this book today? What do you want to look like one year from now? My goal is to help you look your best. I not only want to teach you to lose weight, but I want to make your body feel great. You can reverse age and change your entire world when it comes to how to manage your weight and health. This book will teach you the art of "how to lose weight without being forced to eat what you hate". Eat big portions of foods without limiting yourself.

This book has plans from beginners all the way to super expert plans. Each plan can be utilized at the end. Even as an expert, you will still need to recycle each plan because each plan has a particular purpose, even the very first one. With five programs total, you will always have options. The book also comes with a recipe book. It's filled with good things to eat after your workout. It also comes with sample daily meals plans that are basic and easy to implement. Also included is a huge recipe book with over three hundred recipes to spice up the meals for the rest of your day. My goal is for you to never step on a scale again. Never have you count a calorie again. No tracking, no measuring, no hassles!

A calorie is something we created due to poor meal timing and bad health habits. Never before in human history have we been able

to push a button and have a feast appear in front of us without any effort. Man created calories to compensate for overeating, because with a feast ready at the push of a button, it is easy to eat too much. When we eat naturally, counting anything is a thing of the past! Get the right types of foods at the right times and master your body. I am going to teach you the top of the line health hacks. What you are about to learn today will blow away everything you thought you knew about eating and weight loss? Ditch the labels, throw out the scale and get ready for your new life.

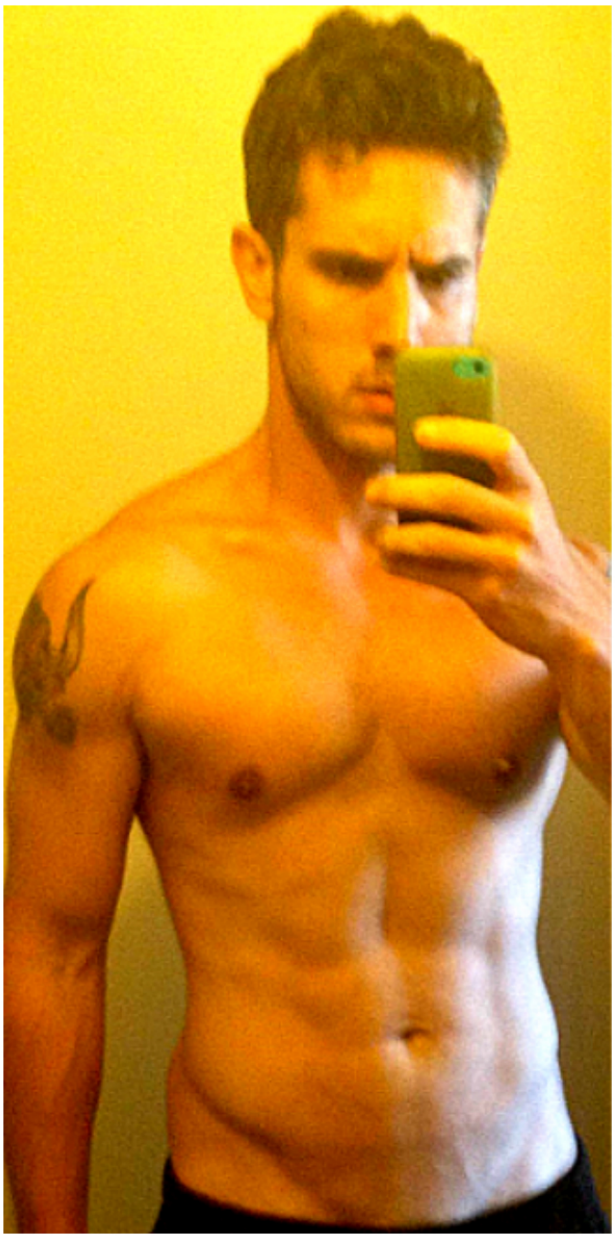
Preface

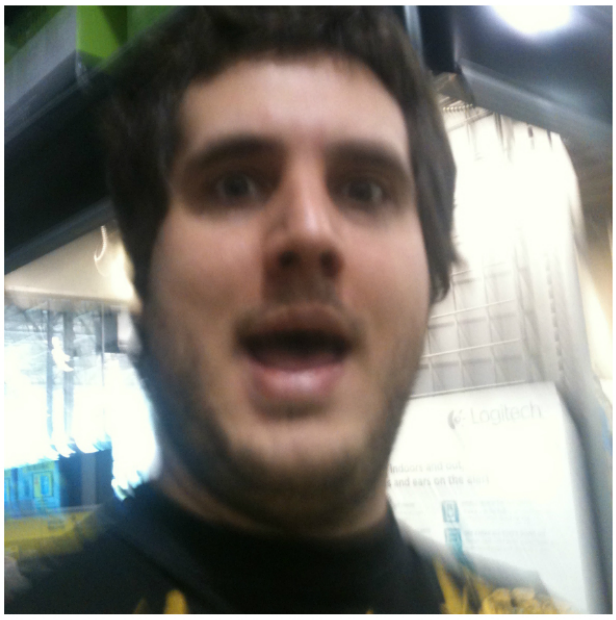
When it rains it pours, and it was raining, and I was walking outside, not because I had somewhere to go, but because I had nowhere to go. I looked over at this dead tree stump and it had this little new tree growing out from the middle of the it.

At the moment, the stump meant nothing to me, but for some reason, years later after I lost 100 pounds and completely changed my life, that tree stump was all I could think of.

I once again found myself on a walk in the rain with no destination in mind.

As the rain cleared I had a moment of clarity. I remembered the dead tree stump, with its new bright green sprout growing out of it. That dead tree I saw, that was me. I was the dead tree, and this new version of myself had developed from the dead carcass of my old life.

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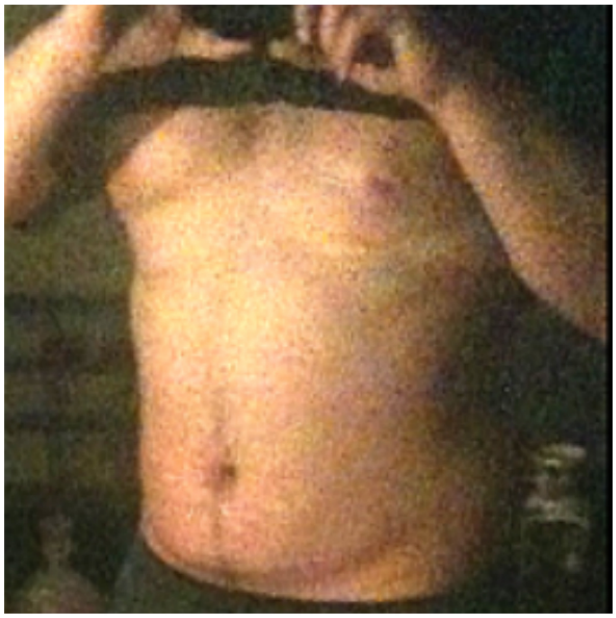

XFORMATION

Part One-My Name is Dan, and this is My Story

One Sentence Changed my Outlook on Life Forever and Set the Tone for my Xformation

1

But first, let me give you some background to better understand why.

If you are reading this book, I presume that you are looking for help. That this is not your first time to try to lose weight. That you are here in hopes you will learn something that will help you finally lose weight, forever.

We live in a world that has run into the most serious trouble: a health epidemic consisting of obesity, heart disease, cancer--any of which are bad enough on their own; but when you add up all the health hazards we face today, it is sickening.

There is a reason you are reading this book right now. You're not happy with how your body is shaped. You woke up and looked in the mirror one too many times and were not happy with what you saw. You're tired of looking at that skirt or pair of pants in the back

of your closet and saying you won't get rid of it because one day you will fit into it again.

I know this feeling all too well. I used to neglect my body without even realizing the damage being done. After high school, I really let my body go to crap, never taking vitamins or omega 3's. I never even cared to get a decent haircut; I just did the buzz cut when my hair got so long it turned into an afro. I never bought clothes, I mostly wore sweat pants and a hoody. I never really left my home or office much either. I focused on my work and figured money was the only way to happiness. I realized this may not be true when I made $35,000 in one night. My friends wanted to go celebrate ... and it hit me. I didn't even want to leave my office, I just wanted to work more. Work harder. Make more. But it was such a short-lived high, the money. It was just some addictive illusion. I realized if I could be so blind in what I thought I wanted, did I even know who I was?

You see, I grew up poorer than all of my friends. My family owned a carpet cleaning business, and we never turned down work, couldn't afford to. One year we were doing really badly. Pawning things just to pay the rent. Finally, we landed a commercial job. My dad quoted 84$ on what I would have estimated a 400$ job at the cheapest. It was hard to compete with the big professional carpet cleaning companies, so we had to go cheap to get any clients.

It was an easy six-man job and took us all day. My dad had me

hit every corner, move every piece of furniture, and double rake. (We raked the carpet to help it dry and leave those cool line patterns). If we had missed a spot, we would have come back and done it for free.

My dad was handed the check and noticed it was for $840. The woman thought it was $840 since $84 was so cheap. My dad called her back immediately, without a single thought. He told her the mistake, and she thanked him--and gave us a 50$ tip.

I'll never forget how my dad didn't even hesitate for a second. $840 was so much money to us back then, and we needed it so badly. I asked my dad why he did it. He simply said: "Because it was the right thing to do."

The funny thing is, those words didn't really change my life until later.

I developed a craving to make money. I didn't want to be poor. And I hit my goal. But I was so focused on money, I let my health deteriorate. I became fat, waking up drinking a coke and eating McDonald's for breakfast. I would wake up every day with terrible stomach pains & headaches. The only water I got was from soft drinks and flavored drinks. I never worked out. I mean, never, unless it was to throw the football with my neighbor. When I first started making decent money, I even paid people to get my fast food for me. I rarely left the house.

I forgot life wasn't just about making money. Money is only one

ingredient in the life cake we bake. You can't focus on one ingredient. You must blend them all together and slowly let it bake. Neither can you rush the process.

Anyone you ask who knew me would have said: "That man can accomplish anything he sets his mind to." This always bugged me because deep down, I knew it was true. But I let myself get fat--really fat. If I couldn't control my own body, how could I control my life?

"Because it's the right thing to do."

I heard it again. As if my Dad were right behind me. Goosebumps ran up my spine. From that moment on, it wasn't a choice I had to make, it was a decision I have made.

I went from the laziest person you can imagine to becoming a health nut and losing hundred pounds while traveling the world, living in different countries and experiencing new adventures. I wanted an exciting life. I wanted the pressure, and the challenges. Money wasn't everything, far from it. My dad knew this. I started to bring balance to my life, realizing that focusing on just business and not my health and personal life was going to eventually leak over and destroy my business. I stopped taking for granted the wonderful gifts I already had. The friends and family who loved me. My precious body, so malnourished, so neglected. I had the confidence of a battered alpha lion. I could never be broken, but the scratches started to show, the wear and tear crept in.

It's amazing how a memory, ten years old, could pop back into

my mind and change my life in an instant. Nothing external did it for me, just my dad's voice.

It's so clear to me now, what my dad really meant. To sell your soul for comfort only leads to ultimate discomfort. I realize now that the best investment I can ever make is in my body and mind. Money comes and goes, but knowledge and a six pack are engraved, molded success that no one can take away or discredit.

The funny thing is, my business is now better than ever. I go out all the time. I have energy. My life is in balance because taking my mind and body seriously was the right thing to do.

Most people have terrible eating patterns and don't know the first thing about the effects of the food they eat. In this book, you will learn everything you need to know about what to eat, when to eat it, and why you are eating it. I'm living proof that new life can grow at any time from death.

Let your old life, old habits, old outlook, let them die to become the fertilizer for your new life!

I extend you an invitation to turn the page and unlock the secrets of weight loss that took me most of my life to learn!

Part Two-The Cold Hard Truth

Understanding the World's Weight Epidemic

2

People are sick and tired of being sick and tired. People are tired of being lied to. The fitness industry still follows an ineffective and antiquated approach to weight loss. At the same time, we have reached a critical point on this planet facing the highest rate of childhood obesity ever, with one out of three children considered obese.

Our society has the highest rate of heart failure and weight-related disease and. From a fitness point of view, we are teetering on destruction! We have more people diagnosed with diabetes in the last ten years, than in the past fifty combined. There is more depression and anti-psychotic medicines on the market than ever before.

"Are you feeling sad?

-Oh, take this pill!

Low energy?

-Oh, we got a pill for that too!"

No one seems to want to fix the problem, only Band-Aid them, instead of digging deep and finding the root causes. I, for one, have had enough! I did the tough research, I spent the time and read the books, and I connected the dots. Then, I took my knowledge and got to work on my goals of losing weight. I failed a lot, but my urge to succeed always brought me back. I kept falling off the horse and getting back on. I would lose ten pounds then gain back twenty. It was one step forward, three steps back. It kept getting worse; the more I tried and failed, the more frustrated I got. I learned the hard way what worked and what didn't. It is now a widely-known fact that commonly held theories regarding weight loss and obesity haven't been subjected to careful testing. This should be a wake-up call for people to always ask for proof about the solutions we hear so widely spread.

We have been raised in a society frightened of pain and discomfort. The sad truth is, many people today have developed an irrational phobia of hunger and food. We live in a culture that trains people it is not ever good to be hungry, and that hunger is risky; obviously, this is partially correct since human beings need food. We as a species would die quicker from lack of water, but the point is when you're hungry it activates the reactive component of our natural survival instincts; which thinks: "I need to eat to go on!"

When you know how to control hunger correctly, it will service

you in many productive ways. Hunger will also activate the active part of the survival instinct, which makes you more alert, energetic, and productive.

People have battled with hunger throughout human history, and not just because they were incapable of affording food or suffering from drought, famine, or misfortune. Learning to deal with hunger was practiced deliberately because people wanted to be capable and vigorous enough to face life's challenges.

You are Your Habits

What you do every day matters. Think of how well you can tie your shoes, or eat and text at the same time with no problems. Pretty simple stuff, sure, but somewhere in the distant past it was difficult, remember? Getting that first shoelace tied right seemed pretty much impossible. Still, you plugged away at it, until one day, after maybe the thousandth time trying you finally got it. Your first bow attempt finally came good, and **the secret to your success** was just simple **repetition.**

Did you know you can develop a great skill at anything if you spend just six hours a day at it for sixty days straight? Just think, in that time you could learn to play the piano, or speak another language, or learn how to program a computer. It's often said that what you do during the day is what you become. Imagine this, if just six hours of doing something each day for sixty days could create

such an impact, what about all the other stuff you've been doing every day up to now?

Are your habits poor? Have you been mastering the art of an unhealthy lifestyle? It's scary to think how all of those terrible habits could have formed by doing the wrong things, for years!

It's not just you though. Another scary thought is the fact that these habits could have been taught to kids. By the time we've reached young adulthood, we are experts in terrible eating habits and have incorrect information about pretty much everything. I speak from experience here. I was a fat kid, like many are today, and I now attribute my weight issues as an adult to the incorrect information I picked up as a child.

The key point here is, through repetition of bad habits based on faulty information, most people are set up to fail. As an overweight child you're almost guaranteed to fail. You may try to lose weight, and find a ton of promising looking information, but you can count on ninety-nine percent of that information being either incomplete or plain wrong, and I don't know which is worse.

When you are wrong, at least it is evident that you are wrong. When something is not working, you quickly realize this and move on. But when the information helps a little and it's incomplete, you can find yourself caught in a **vicious circle**. A good example of this is crash dieting. It appears to work because you starve yourself and the scale heads in the right direction for a while. You think this

tactic is the answer you've been looking for, but the truth is, you lost lean tissue as your body raided your muscles for quick energy, and virtually none of the fat shifted at all.

It is easy to think, "Well, it worked once, it can work again!" It won't. You keep repeating your behavior based on the same piece of bad information, following the first phase of a faulty plan, over and over again. It's not just a vicious circle, it's a downward spiral!

People lose weight and then tell their friends how they did it, full of pride. But when they gain it back again, they will often find some excuse to explain why that happened, and later go back to the faulty method in spite of the evidence against it. They will repeat what they did last time, lose a little, gain it back, and around it goes again. They carry on with this one step forward, two steps back approach because they don't like admitting they might be wrong. Also, we are creatures of habit, and often revert back to the familiar.

On the other hand, frustration at the lack of great success can lead people to build resentment towards overweight people. The more times people lose weight, gain it back, lose weight and gain it back, the more this resentment builds. They can justify it in their heads because they worked so hard and feel like they've earned the right to look down on those who don’t. Sometimes this is done consciously, sometimes not.

When judging other people, we actually judge ourselves, but in an indirect manner. We judge others based on how we think we would feel in their shoes. For instance, we may look at someone who is obese but seems contented with themselves and think: "Ugh, what a lazy person! I cannot stand fat people!" But, what we are really saying is: "How dare you be happy? I wouldn't be happy if I were overweight, so you should not be either." The ego comes under indirect attack when someone enjoys themselves in a situation that we could not. Deep down, we are jealous; jealous that someone could be content in a situation that we couldn't stand.

The ego is very good at defense and doesn't like being threatened.

When I lost hundred pounds, I walked in the obese person's shoes; I understood the real struggles of losing weight. Misinformation is rampant and kept me in the dark and overweight for most of my adult life. Being overweight is bad enough, but it's the prejudices of others that make it even worse. Stereotypes are everywhere, and come from a place of fear. You shouldn't judge a book by its cover, but people do. They look at the body you are in and think it can tell them everything they need to know about your character. They sneer at you the same way that they would sneer at someone with dementia, because secretly they're scared it could happen to them.

Being truly honest with ourselves will put an end to stereotypes. We can learn not to judge when our insecurities don't

come to the surface, and then we can originate healthier thoughts and feelings from a perspective of understanding and willingness to learn.

I've heard talk all my life of overweight people being unproductive, that they suffer from a lack of discipline and willpower, and some people want to just chalk it up to sheer laziness. But nothing could be further from the truth! A lot of overweight people are constantly at war with their own minds and bodies, and anyone who thinks that doesn't take discipline and willpower is wrong.

Is it the laziness of individuals or the lack of information?

The real truth is, most overweight people actually have a lot of willpower. These people can go without eating, no problem; it's just that when they start eating, or find themselves in a situation that's conducive to eating, it gets out of hand, so the key is to control the situation.

Intermittent fasting (IF), means fitting your entire calorie intake into a timed window; generally, 6-10 hours are what most people do. The IF approach is what helped me push this avalanche of food consumption to a much later part of the day. The simple idea behind this is, people can only eat so much food at one time before it fills them up. If bigger meals are eaten but fewer of them, overall calorie consumption is lowered, because the extra size of the one meal won't

add up to more calories than the many smaller meals. This worked really well for me and it's been the key to my lasting weight loss.

Everyone is different. I know the "perfect day" for weight loss based on my previous day, week or month for my goals. But guess what? I love pizza and hamburgers with crispy fries! I know myself, and if there's something delicious in the house, it's fifty/fifty whether it'll survive the night. So, my exact plan might not work for you. For yours to work, you have to know yourself too. “Nosce te ipsum.”

When looking for a diet or some kind of eating arrangement that could fit my lifestyle, there was nothing available. I would always do the big name diets, or diets that I heard had worked for my friends. Nothing seemed to cut it though, because even when I would lose the weight, it didn't feel right; I never had energy, and my skin complex got worse. Eventually, the latest diet stopped working. I knew if I was going to figure this thing out I had to go beyond the big name diets and learn how the body works.

Like most of you, the first thing I learned when trying to lose weight was "Caloric deficit equals weight loss." Yes, this is true, but (!) this is also taken way out of context by most individuals. I've found I don't need to count calories, and the entire notion of caloric deficit and caloric maintenance or surplus, basal metabolic rate and all of the unnecessary equations used to magically come up with your resting calorie expenditure are not something I ever have to think about.

How many calories are needed in any given day has a lot to do with how a person feels on that day. Theory can be rigid, and this is a case of theory colliding with the real world. I don't need a calculator to make weight loss work. I like to keep it simple and eat enough when I need to and eat less when I don't. **Do not worry about the calorie content because meal timing is all that matters**, and this works fine so long as I don't put myself in situations where I can over eat or under eat.

The takeaway here is: do not worry about calories, worry about timing. Yes, calories are a way of measuring food intake, but in a system that is flawed. People can go into a caloric deficit on many of these diets, but they do it in an inefficient manner. They will eat the food too early in the day, or they will eat too much food in one go (and at the wrong time), or the wrong type of food.

Properly timing your windows of eating is the key to understanding the basics of fat loss and muscle gain. If you can eat big when you're supposed to, counting calories becomes a thing of the past. Using terms like 'caloric surplus', 'deficit', or 'maintenance', all this is fine and they are always the 'north star' to guide us if all else fails; but there is a lot more fat to be burned and health benefits to be gained when we learn to work with our body's natural rhythms instead of fighting against them.

Decoding the Weight Loss System

3

Some people may not know the difference between caloric deficit and fasting, two important weight loss factors. Comparing them is similar to comparing a turbo booster to a race car. Intermittent fasting is like a turbo booster, and caloric reduction is like a race car. The key difference is, a turbo booster doesn't work if it's not attached to a car. The car will still work fine. But, if you added the turbo booster to the car and took advantage of both, you would see much better results! The caloric deficit should be looked at as the required base to make fasting more effective. It's 100% necessary to burn more calories than you consume in a day for the body to lose weight. Fasting has a similar effect, and you will be losing body fat a lot quicker. Now, just because the caloric deficit is like a race car does not mean it is the only thing that matters. Cars need maintenance and gas and other things to keep them running.

People hear caloric deficit and think that's their only goal. “If I’m always in a caloric deficit, then I will always lose the weight!” Right, guys? Guys? So, they start a diet (all diets put you in caloric deficit thus ALL DIETS WORK AT FIRST), go into a caloric deficit for too long, and their bodies start to adapt, which leads to a relapse. You see, you can go on a diet for a month and lose "X" number of pounds. You continue to monitor your weight and stay in

a caloric deficit, yet the weight loss slows. Yes, you can remain in a caloric deficit forever, and you'll eventually become skin and bones, but before that happens, you start to lose energy and gain massive cravings.

The cravings get to the point where they affect your work, and you cave into them and eat snack foods. This is unavoidable. It makes you feel bad that you "relapsed" and you go running back to the weight loss center to get a new program. You think, "Well it must be me, I don't have the willpower, I lack the strength, I need the support." You get a new diet with your regained willpower prior to the "relapse," and start to lose weight, and the cycle continues. The only reason you'll lose weight again is if you fall into another relapse. You must gain fat to lose fat. You go to the weight loss center, diet, lose weight, relapse, gain weight and so on until the madness just continues and you can never achieve the body you want. You always seem to gain the weight back. This will be a never-ending cycle. Until you figure out how your body works, you'll ALWAYS have weight problems, GUARANTEED.

Tony Does Not Give a Damn about You

The part that's such a shame is most of the people I've helped are so strong, determined, and confident. They're just caught in a hamster wheel running themselves dead tired. Everyone gets exhausted from it after a while. It's set up for you to lose because there is

a lot less money in curing the weight problem and a hell of a lot more money in keeping you overweight. You see this happen with pharmaceutical companies--they never want to cure the disease, just put you at ease. The big companies keep making money off the Band-Aid effect. It's sad because the brightest minds take what their schools teach them as the truth and never question it. A lot of doctors out there, who are very smart, are still telling overweight people to eat carbs for breakfast. And of course, most people never question their doctors! You take what they say as the truth.

This is how misinformation becomes ingrained into a culture, and how Tony the Tiger stays rich. Tony doesn't give a damn about you or your health! None of them do. It's a profit game. They play on your emotions and frustration caused by your lack of knowledge of the fundamentals of weight loss. When people relapse, some get so down they actually hate themselves. Therefore, we must break the cycle, open our eyes, and really take the time to know how a particular diet plan works. Don't just blindly accept it! The biggest rip off is buying a pre-made diet or cookie cutter workout program.

Your body is your most important asset, so get a plan that's tailored to you and know every aspect of it. Buying an exercise plan or diet routine without getting it customized is like buying clothes online. Yes, you might get a good deal, but the clothes won't fit perfectly. I just cringe when I see an advertisement selling an "all-in-one pre-made solution." There are so many variables and

moving parts that you are literally throwing your money away if you buy a guide without having a professional revise it to fit your specific situation. This could be the difference between losing weight or not.

For over ninety-nine percent of routines I revise, the person bought some plan that eventually stopped working. I've revised over six thousand routines to date. That's six thousand case studies. So, when I give you my advice, it's not just what worked for me, it's what thousands of people were doing wrong. These are the results of the routines with the top three most common similarities: Eating an early breakfast, not eating carbohydrates, or a restrictive caloric diet for over two weeks. Does any of this sound familiar to you? Remember, you can't get a refund on your wasted time or fruitless effort.

Regardless of what I say, do your research, please. Learn from people who have been there and done what you're trying to do. Trying to lose sixty pounds? Don't follow the advice of a fitness trainer who has never been overweight. Some people are born with higher metabolisms and were never fat. They couldn't possibly know how to advise you. How could they? Even if they researched how, they could never field test their findings and could never see what actually does work. I've studied and found that "theory" in the weight-loss world is far, far, far from what works in practice. And trying to play the guessing game can be like playing with fire. Getting it wrong

too often is not good for your body, and some of the damage is permanent. Here's a reality check . . . Once you get fat, the fat cells are a part of you--forever. That's why when you're looking to all of these muscular fitness models for guidance, you don't realize they built muscle at a young age and never experienced being fat. They'll always have an edge you won't have when it comes to building muscle while simultaneously gaining less fat. Buying their "Hollywood diet" is the wrong move for people who've had weight issues. You don't have to be a genius to tell people to how lose weight fast. "Buy my food guide; it works better." "NO! My food guide is the best." "Well wait a minute, you people got it all wrong . . . you gotta drink this shake standing on your head!" I was pulled in every direction.

Wait . . . Am I Living in the Fat Matrix?!

I learned that all of these "diets" had one thing in common: they put you below caloric maintenance. I saw a study that a professor performed, called the "Twinkies diet," where he lost twenty-seven pounds in ten weeks eating mostly junk food like Twinkies. Of course, to keep it off with that same diet is a whole different story. Going into a caloric deficit after a person has been in a caloric surplus for an extended period (more than a week), that person will lose weight guaranteed. The "Atkins diet" for example, many people lost a lot of weight by avoiding carbs and eating all the meat they wanted.

My mom did this. I've done this. The Atkins diet is not nearly as popular as it once was. It has a cult following still. "It worked once; it will work again!" I always hear people say that. You know now that ANY diet will work once. But, inevitably, you gain the weight back and can't keep it off. You see, I have a six pack all year around, with ease. The eating schedule is not a diet for me; it's an optimal meal timing routine for effortless eating. When I say timing, I mean when I eat breakfast. There is a trick, yes, and it's not going to work to just be in a deficit.

People are wising up and starting to realize low-calorie all the time is not the answer, and it's not. Far from it. When I first got into this, I didn't really expect anything. I never expected to ever have a six pack. I went from an overweight and unhealthy person with the worst habits, to developing the best habits and getting a top one percent physique. The reason I struggled is, I believe, the same reason you do: misinformation. People are also starting to realize that eating breakfast in the morning all the time is not such a smart move. The term "intermittent fasting" is misunderstood. People don't realize how hard it was to get food in abundance through human history. It wasn't every day you could drive up to a McDonald's window and order a one thousand calorie meal. Certain addictive food has many calories; it's easy to overeat. Hormone control is more relevant than ever in modern society because we're able at the touch of a cell phone to order vast quantities of food delivered right to

our doorsteps.

With so much food at our fingertips, the lean muscles ceased to have a purpose in most people's lives, and now we face an obesity epidemic the likes of which we've never seen before. People must realize how the body works; it's not a fat burning machine, it's quite the opposite. The truth is the body is very proficient at storing fat, and losing it requires a process of ebb and flow. Go with too few calories for too long, and you'll experience weight gain eventually; your body will want to store as much fat as possible.

I am your hormones, nice to meet you!

Below are some of the human bodies most powerful hormones. Learning to manipulate these hormones for our benefit is as close to superhuman as we currently can get.

Human growth hormone (HGH) or somatotropin are manufactured by the pituitary gland. Both have seemingly magical capabilities and can act as a protein replacement when needed. Growth hormone raises the synthesis of lean muscle and the storage of glycogen and fat. To name a few more benefits of HGH: it improves strength, exercise endurance, skin, hair, mood, energy, healing, and flexibility, resistance to disease, libido, and memory. It also reduces body fat, stress, cravings while balancing hormones and reversing aging. HGH also burns triglyceride levels (primary fat source in the body) while reducing inflammation and lessening damage from free radicals. This

is that "hard to reach fat" that everyone complains about.

Insulin is a protein, and it is produced and released by the pancreas whenever we eat carbs, protein, or both (carbs raise insulin substantially more than protein and fat does not increase insulin at all really). Unlike normal proteins that are the physical building blocks of muscle, this is a functional protein, much like HGH. Insulin, when timed and harnessed correctly, will induce more growth than HGH. When insulin is regulated it combats food cravings by balancing ghrelin levels, also known as "the hunger hormone." This helps eliminate artificial food cravings and regulate digestion. The fundamental difference between the two is insulin can be more powerful but creates unwanted fat growth. HGH stimulates muscle growth and burns fat. It literally turns our bodies into fat burning machines. By utilizing these two elements, we can burn fat at the maximum rate while preserving muscle and balancing our hormones to end artificial food cravings. This desired fat loss can be achieved by staying hydrated and getting the most out of your daily insulin and HGH spurts.

Glucagon a hormone secreted by the pancreas. Glucagon stimulates the production of ketone bodies during the metabolism of fats, aka ketogenesis, by doing the opposite of insulin.

Cortisol is created in the zona fasciculata of the adrenal cortex inside the adrenal gland. During stress cortisol releases. It operates to raise blood sugar by gluconeogenesis, to repress the

immune system, and to assist in the metabolism of all macronutrients: fat, protein, and carbohydrates. Cortisol is the exact opposite of insulin. We know now insulin is anabolic. What about Cortisol? Cortisol is catabolic. Being anabolic builds us up and being catabolic breaks us down. Cortisol is at its peak right when you wake up. Eating of any kind, (more than 60 calories) causes us to become anabolic. In the morning we want to be catabolic to break down fat faster and more efficiently. We do not want to be anabolic, which is a growing environment for fat gain. Cortisol and HGH can be at high levels at the same time, unlike HGH and insulin.

Leptin is a circulating hormone manufactured by fat, which is dumped into the bloodstream and then seeks the brain and binds to the areas of the brain that are responsible for appetite. Leptin is directly involved in our feeding behavior and energy homeostasis. This hormone also enables wounds to heal faster and strengthens our immune system by activating T-cells.

Adiponectin is a protein which is generated by subcutaneous fat, aka the healthier fat. Adiponectin is involved in regulating glucose levels, fatty acid breakdown, and keeps our blood clear of harmful toxins and fats. Learning to utilize adiponectin by attacking visceral fat (the bad fat) is key to staying at peak health and strength while losing weight.

Ghrelin, aka, "the hunger hormone." is a peptide hormone that is produced mostly in the area of the stomach that stimulates the

secretion of growth hormone from the pituitary gland. Ghrelin is responsible for controlling appetite levels and can have an effect on mental health and energy levels.

Body fat from a different perspective

Fat is our natural source of fuel, and the body is perfectly content to lay around all day eating food and gaining fat. That is why it does this so well. How many people do you know who gain muscle this easily? Muscle is only needed during adverse situations; fat is necessary just to survive in general. The body doesn't need adverse circumstances to survive; it does, however, need fat to burn as fuel. Therefore, the body is much more receptive to gaining fat rather than losing it. We think of fat as harmful extra storage, but researchers have reached a different conclusion: fat is a vital organ that releases necessary hormones and sends critical information to the brain. Fat is so damn significant; the body will work as hard as it can to defend it. Thus, the war on fat is not one to be taken lightly, because fat has an ally, and this ally is the most powerful ally we have on this physical earth, which is the body. We must battle our body, train our bodies like a bonsai tree, impose our will to carve the design we are seeking.

The word diet has the word die in it for a reason.

When we go into a caloric deficit, we are slowing dying, losing body mass. If you abuse low calorie eating plans for extended periods

of time, all of your hormones will suffer, and your overall health will decline. We must gain weight to lose weight. Fat produces adiponectin, a protein that is vital to our good health.

Good Fat Versus Bad Fat

There are two key differences between fats: subcutaneous fat and visceral fat. The good type of fat that is the primary generator of leptin and adiponectin is called subcutaneous, found directly under our skin in places such as our abdomens, thighs, buttocks and arms. Subcutaneous fat differentiates from visceral fat in a significant number of ways. Visceral fatty tissue collects beneath the stomach wall, right against the internal organs. Visceral fat is bad, and our first goal should be to get rid of it. If this fat were to become inflamed it would lead to severe medical conditions such as diabetes, heart disease, and cancer to name a few.

Study after study has proven to show the adverse effects of low calorie and low carbohydrate diets if done incorrectly or abused. Another study with mice showed that the obese mice had a genetic defect in their fat that prevented them from making functional leptin and getting the signal to stop eating. This defect in humans could lead to a person eating themselves to death!

Fat's relationship with leptin poses a great dilemma because when losing fatty tissue, we also have decreased levels of leptin. As levels of leptin begin to decline more and more, the hunger levels

humans experience will raise in parallel. Leptin also affects our muscles and thyroid hormones, and decreased quantities of it will stall our metabolism. All of the attribute to lower leptin levels causing weight gain.

How do we combat this evil fat? Fight FAT with FAT!

By creating adiponectin, subcutaneous fat leads circulating fats in the blood out of our veins and into the subcutaneous fatty tissues where they should be. Adiponectin also reduces the evil visceral fat. The best ways to attack the bad fat are resistance training and intermittent fasting because they both promote the release of adiponectin.

Did you know that fat can affect your brain size? Yes, leptin plays a significant role in brain growth and development. People who are leptin-deficient on average have tinier total brain volume. A study on mice which were leptin-deficient showed to have many phenotypic anomalies containing brains that are tinier, weighed less and overall had less cortical mass. When monitoring the effects of leptin control on brain growth; Intraperitoneal injections of leptin for two weeks daily to mice that were four-weeks-old showcased ten percent increase in brain weight, dry or wet, with almost a twenty percent rise in overall brain DNA.

As a society in a whole, we fail to realize how important fat really is and we should be more appreciative of our reserved energy

stores. Our culture is fixated on losing fat, but moderate amounts of the healthy fat will improve our health. The goal should be to attack and get rid of visceral fat, which is directly linked to diseases. There is a method of eating that directly attacks the evil visceral fat while preserving the healthier subcutaneous fat emergency use. Hint: the method of eating I am referring includes breakfast. . . but not in the manner you are traditionally taught to think.

Santa Clause Isn’t Real & Breakfast is Bad For You

4

Speaking of "Breakfast". . . What a terribly misunderstood word! A lot of people get this concept plain wrong. Most people do not even understand the meaning of breakfast when they use it. People tend to think that breakfast means eating right when you wake up. As a culture with food abundance, people simply started to break their fast early in the am. Breakfast means "Break-Fast." It has no correlation with when to eat. Of course, around the 1950's "Break-Fast" turned to "Breakfast" and people in the West assumed it was natural to eat in the morning. The point is, you can't skip breakfast, you can only delay it. Our hunter-gatherer ancestors did not have the luxury of eating breakfast in the morning consistently. Their metabolisms formed from spurts of feast & famine, and that is why we can go weeks without eating and still survive.

The magic behind our ability to survive without food for an extended period of time is because the pituitary gland gives our bodies the capacity to produce human growth hormone (HGH) and somatotropin, which is the body's way to combat starvation. Delayed eating causes a massive increase in the levels of the growth hormone by up to one thousand percent normal levels; this sharp rise happens just thirteen hours after starting your fast and keeps raising until you break your fast. The increase in HGH will stimulate the breakdown

of fatty tissue because our body needs the fat to produce energy. The improvement in HGH during fasting benefits to protect our muscle tissue and glycogen stores because it uses our fat stores for fuel instead. This breakdown of fat, which is termed: "lipolysis," releases free fatty acids and glycerol, which are then metabolized to create energy. Fasting plays a major role in not only regulating lipolysis, by actually optimizing it.

Breakfast is the Most Important Meal of the Day?

As you can start to add up, "breakfast" is not the most important meal of the day; not only is it unimportant, but it's also by far the unhealthiest.

We should not breakfast in the morning. Spiking insulin early in the day, every day puts a halt to everything we want. It stops HGH production when it is at its highest. It stops the fat burning process. We guarantee ourselves a blood sugar low later in the day. It saps us of our energy, our motivation, and makes us less sharp. Cortisol and HGH are at their peaks in the mornings. Both of these powerful hormones burn fat. Insulin is at its lowest for the day in the morning--remember, insulin is anabolic and makes everything grow from skin to muscles and... Fat! Keep in mind, your fat-burning hormones are at their peak in the morning when you don't eat, and your anabolic hormone is at its lowest. If you eat, it reverses, and your fat burning hormones are blunted, and your insulin is raised;

this leads to gaining fat, not burning it. Fasting also improves metabolism and makes our body burn more calories throughout the day.

The metabolic impact occurring from excessive insulin production can be bypassed by controlling meal timing, most importantly, carbohydrates timing. This metabolic improvement is so noticeable that some of you will have more energy and be able to lose weight eating larger, tastier meals than you've been eating! Diets that are high in carbohydrates for morning breakfast are exactly what most overweight people don't need and will never lead to permanent weight management. The world's epidemics of diabetes, heart disease, and high blood pressure are the direct consequences of our overconsumption of food, mainly our food timing when it comes to carbohydrates and its association to hyperinsulinism. My approach can and has corrected these serious risk factors associated with obesity.

When we eat breakfast, we naturally become slower versions of ourselves. When we first wake up, before eating HGH is at its peak, it boosts cognitive functions such as memory, focus, and increases our alertness. During this time, insulin is lowered. While insulin is low, the brain produces norepinephrine, a hormone that is discharged by the adrenal medulla and sympathetic nerves, and functions as a neurotransmitter. Norepinephrine increases alertness, arousal, promotes vigilance, enhances formation and retrieval of memory, and increases the ability to focus and pay

attention. Epinephrine (commonly known as adrenalin or adrenaline), is also created while insulin is low. Adrenaline is a hormone produced by both the adrenal glands and individual neurons. It plays a significant role in the fight-or-flight response by enhancing blood flow to muscles, the output of the heart, pupil dilation, and blood sugar. It does this by its effects on alpha and beta receptors found in many animals.

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We become sharper; this is a defense mechanism built into us. As hunter-gatherers, when we grew hungrier, our senses became more sharpened. All of our hormones become normalized from leptin to ghrelin, and we actually attack the real fat by lowering our triglyceride levels. Artificial cravings cease to exist; once the fat is restored as an active fuel supply, we'll see better energy, more stable moods, greater mental clarity, deeper sleep, fewer cravings, and natural and permanent weight management. With that said, I breakfast in the morning. . . Yes, I'm a breakfast eater. I admit it. . . I breakfast in the morning once a week, on my feast

day. This gives our body a rest from HGH production, so we don't stunt our HGH levels by constant distress. Distress is good, but only in controlled measures. This allows it to release our most powerful natural hormones.

Caloric Theories that Don't Hold Up in Practice

The reason many people are confused about this theory is that they think of it as a static caloric base. However, the caloric base is far from static. To say that I need two thousand calories to meet the base each day is incorrect. The time at which you consume the calories is the most important; therefore, it is of concern when and how the calories were consumed. Spreading out two thousand calories throughout the day is NOT the same as burning two thousand calories in a condensed window with the bulk of it coming after a workout. One must think of their body as a clean slate when it comes time to breakfast. This means the later you can work out, the more you can benefit from this. Therefore, from the point of any food consumed, it should be looked at as a new cycle or to make it clearer, a new day. There are mini days or windows which can be set up in one twenty-four-hour period. A long fast, for example, until 7 PM, would begin at the hour you woke up until the time mentioned above. Hence, it is a mini day because you have burned nothing but fat up until this point with the fasting. Eating the bulk of calories after a late workout will cause both muscle gain and fat loss the next day.

Often you hear someone say that to build muscle, you need a calorie surplus. This is true, but people often misinterpret its meaning. They eat in a frenzied manner the entire day, which does add a lot of muscle but also a lot of fat. The reason it's lopsided is that for muscles to grow, there needs to be a surplus of calories, as they need sufficient energy to build and repair new muscle tissue. To use an illustration, if one eats too early in the day and works out later in the day before they start the exercise, the body has burned no fat. That is, it has been burning the food you have eaten. Thus, once you exercise, your body is in need of the calorie surplus, and the calories you have consumed previously don't count as they are being used to maintain energy the entire day. This leads to over-eating to gain muscle.

I use the same concept, but instead of having a big meal early in the day, I push my meal to after my workout time, so the calorie surplus comes into effect at a time my muscles need it the most. I can gain muscle, yet, be in a caloric deficit for the day. This is how one builds muscle and burns fat at the same time. Eat until you're full, include lots of protein and carbs in your diet, and you're on the right track.

It is no longer just an anecdote anymore; there is increasing evidence to support this.

The false evidence is piling up, just look at the Food Guide

Pyramid, created by the U.S. Department of Agriculture. In this guide, the department recommends six to eleven daily servings of carbohydrates, especially consuming them first thing in the morning which is the basis of the pyramid. This misinformation given through these recommendations have directly contributed to widespread obesity and diabetes. There are numerous instances in history where a certain thing was believed to be correct, but it turned out that it is, in fact, wrong. Remember, humans once collectively were sure the earth was flat (some still do!). But humanity learns from their erroneous ways, makes progress and corrects their missteps. It's only recently that people have begun questioning what they have been taught about eating practices.

If an individual has been overweight for a long period of time, he/she probably suffers from some form of insulin resistance and/or a metabolic disorder. This means that refined carbohydrates which include sugars, white flour products, and junk foods will slowly poison him/her. The fact is an insulin level which erratically spikes for extended stretches of time, eventually, leads to insulin resistance.

Insulin resistance leads to:

- Diabetes/Type II diabetes
- Obesity
- Lipid disorders

- Thyroid disorders
- Hyperinsulinism
- High blood pressure
- Coronary heart disease.

Obesity occurs when the body's process by which it turns food into fuel malfunctions.

The more obese a person is, the greater the chance of the existence of a metabolic abnormality. The basis of metabolic disorder in obesity happens because of eating too many calories at the wrong times. The primary reason of problem stems is mistimed carbohydrates. The metabolic disorders derived from poor meal timing frequently occur as clusters and constitutes of the metabolic syndrome. Insulin resistance plays a crucial role in the pathogenesis of this syndrome, and it's the root of all these terrible health problems. These metabolic challenges and diseases, which are prevalent in the world today, can be solved or minimized with proper meal timing.

The Test that Fooled the World

The test conducted on the premise that skipping breakfast is healthy was not done on a suitable sample of individuals. It was done solely by individuals who regularly skipped breakfast versus people who ate breakfast consistently. One of the observations about people who skipped breakfast was: "These people as a whole also tend to drink

more, gain more weight and smoke cigarettes." Most of these individuals did not just skip breakfast for health reasons; they did it because they didn't have time in the morning. One can conclude that an unhealthy and undisciplined lifestyle was the leading cause of skipping breakfast. The fact that these individuals smoked cigarettes and drank more alcohol in comparison to people who ate breakfast shows that they are not the most health-conscious people, and, in fact, they lead a fast and stressful life, resulting in weight gain. They are making and practicing unhealthy lifestyle choices.

When delaying breakfast, the body needs to be healthy to handle the stress of fasting. When properly nourished, an individual does not get huge cravings for food, unlike malnourished individuals. A healthy body is built to function weeks without food. Fasting is an art; you must PREPARE yourself to fast! Knowing the benefits of fasting going in will help you when times are hard. These tests were performed on unmotivated individuals. People who were delaying breakfast by accident; nowhere in these studies does it say if they drank enough water in the morning (absolutely critical for fasting). Did they take omega 3's in the morning (no)? Did they exercise regularly (no)? Even if a seasoned professional, like myself, did not perform the steps mentioned above, I would spectacularly fail.

There has been a drastic improvement in my blood work since creating this eating plan; my Doctor even recommended fasting to some

of his close friends!

I should become a doctor; they would call me Dr. Dan.

Instead of speaking of my experience and my results. . . I'll speak from a piece of paper saying: "I know what I'm talking about." Unfortunately, most people think they know best. They approach life with the facts they see on paper instead of in real life. There are many examples of this misplaced trust in life. For example, you might go on a fishing trip and on arrival see a local fisherman with a boatload of fish coming back to the dock. To the right of the local, you spot a captain with no fish on his ship as he comes back to the dock. Most people still would choose the captain to pick his brain about the best spots for fishing. This means that instead of listening to the local who may have mastered fishing, you talk to the captain because of his titled "professional expertise."

One in three children today is obese! Wake up, people! Stop avoiding the truth because you're afraid to admit you blindly followed the wrong health practices your entire life. I have had that realization; I have eaten breakfast almost ninety-five percent of the time in my life. I find it hard to acknowledge that I indulged in unhealthy habits for such a long period. It is easy to say, "Well, I followed the diet plan; it is not my fault!" You can believe in ill-informing government studies, or you can wake up, look around,

realize something is terribly, terribly wrong. Don't be so naive to think large corporations won't misguide you just to earn exponential profits.

Eating breakfast more than twice a week is simply not good for your health. And it can be seen, as one in three people today are considered obese! Genetics and activity play a significant role such as with professional athletes and body builders. They have been blessed with good genetics, and they complement that with working out, therefore, they have a surplus of HGH secretion. People with gifted genes do not gain weight easily DESPITE eating in the morning because their body burns so many more calories. But, for an average person who sits at a desk all day, this is not the case. **Thus, one in three. . .**

Part Three-Ropes End

Not What You Eat, It’s When You Eat It

6

I didn't get into losing weight because I'm a health nut, or because I was trying to improve my looks. I lost one hundred pounds because I had something to prove to myself. I am still the same old fat kid inside I was before, but now I am trapped in an athletic and sculpted body.

When I first began promoting my weight loss perspectives, people would criticize me and call me a quack for not telling them to eat chicken and salad at every meal. People were confused because they had never had a fat kid tell them how to lose weight. I never, ever, switched what I ate. If I did that, I would rather be fat again. I love food way too much. I still eat pizza, and cake, and pies, and hamburgers all the time. When I created this formula, it was all about keeping the spirit of the fat kid alive. I kept it simple. Instead of trying to conform to an eating "window," I just eat five to eight hours after waking. The amazing thing is that as you attune to your body, this new window becomes the new "natural" based on your new energy levels and appetite. I love eating at night, for example, so I don't like the idea of fitting into any kind of artificial window.

Instead of eating like a slob right after I woke up, I made a

game of "earning the meal" via workouts. I found a way to make it work without changing who I was deep down. I want to prove to the world that you do not have to suffer to lose weight, you can literally lose it eating like a fat kid.

I made everything as simple as possible, breaking down everything. This program includes foods that leave you feeling much fuller and more satisfied. On most diets, you will be counting calories. On most diets, you will not learn how to make a gradual transition to a lifetime maintenance plan. After reading this book, you will learn how to develop a healthy way to eat that will feel comfortable and natural enough to adopt for good. This book disproves all the infamous low carb diets, all the juicing diets, the "healthy" food diets and any other kind of bogus diet that is widely marketed today. This is a personal eating plan; we are not as far removed from caves as we like to think we are. Ancient humans ate like savages, eating very sporadically. Just adopting our natural physical ebb and flow with our hormones, I learned to maximize my health by going with my natural rhythm. This book challenges everything, asks the hard questions, and gives truthful answers. This will revolutionize the way you look at losing weight, forever!

Fixing the Inputs

The other day I was having dinner with some people, and the

conversation got around to how they were unhappy with their lives. These guys were not obese, but they were not happy with the body they were in either. Instead of learning how to fix the problems these people just wanted to complain about how their results suck and that there's nothing they can do about it and how the outcome was inevitable and doomed from the start. The people in question were spending their free time going out and having a "fun time"; aka they drank almost every day and focused more on having a good time than actually improving their lives. They read zero material on health or how the body works. They worked the standard forty hours per week and used that as an excuse to skip working out. Now, from my perspective, these people deserve every messed-up output they received, considering their inputs were complete crap. I want to make it clear first that I am entirely receptive to people struggling and working it out and things not going well, that is life, and when that happens, it sucks. When I can lend people a hand, I do. I also want to make it clear that if you are not creating good habits and the output is garbage, you can just change the inputs; the problem starts with you.

From my perspective, personal development is a pretty logical process. You start with habits, because those set the foundation of what you are going to do with most of your time. It takes work because changing habits is a pain in the ass. Reversion to old habits is easy, and that is why most people quit. Good habits are reading, exercising,

productive hobbies: working, studying your field, spending quality time with friends and family, etc.

Bad habits are drug or alcohol abuse, partying, watching too much television, and things that get you nowhere just as fast as the healthy habits get you somewhere. A little bit of any of these is fine; that means they are not habitual.

From creating healthy habits, you can start to refine your behavior if you are trying to accomplish something. You will not lose hundred pounds in four months if all those things are not perfectly balanced. It will be very close to impossible. That is fine if that is not your goal. However, you should sit down and make sure that you have set yourself up reasonably to meet your goals, so that you are not disappointed with an utterly predictable result. Moreover, you should not complain uselessly and ruin other people's otherwise enjoyable dinner, if all of the inputs into your system do not add up anywhere close to your desired output. Accomplishing difficult tasks takes focus, tuning things out, and relentless dedication.

I understand when things are tough. Also, I know that not everyone wants a ripped body, if it has a price is hard work. There is an old saying: “People miss opportunities because usually it is dressed up in overalls and called work.”

Everyone wants six pack abs, but almost no one I meet is willing to pay the price for them. The point is to think about your life as a system and to focus on how to optimize the system. If the diet is

what makes you gain weight, then why does everyone focus solely on the workout part? Both areas of the system are critical, and I can argue that diet is way more significant than the exercise.

The way most people try to accomplish things is very one-dimensional and ineffective. To succeed, you must maximize the number of positive feedback loops moving in the same direction. Diet, exercise, mind state - everything flowing in the right direction. It is not that hard to accomplish what you want if you have everything going one way and pushing you down the conveyor belt towards your goal. When you are pulled in many different directions, and there's no consistent flow reaching across all the different components of your life, then you cannot expect to go anywhere quickly, and should, in general, expect to be sunk. I know this because I was stuck for years, grappling with misinformation, excuses, and failure to make it work.

Overnight Success

7

It is funny because people think I lost the weight very quickly, which while literally true is not the entire story. Before I lost a hundred pounds in less than four months, I spent most of my life on the other side of it, overweight. I spent my entire childhood and ninety-five percent of my adult life with weight issues.

It's not easy as a kid when you lose the weight, and everyone congratulates you, then you gain it back. It's not easy when real friends inadvertently roll their eyes when you say you are dieting. It is not easy when your mom tells the whole family you lost so much weight, just to gain it back before seeing them. It is humiliating to have friends and relatives making excuses for you about why you are struggling to lose the weight. Going to more schools as a kid then there were grades; I went to five different schools during elementary, and at each, I was referred to as the new "fat kid."

As an adult I got to be over two hundred eighty-five pounds; I say over because I threw my scale away after getting above that number. Talk about rock bottom. Besides, I did not get any lighter after that, but rather much heavier, I would not be surprised if I cleared three hundred pounds with ease.

I like "The Chinese Bamboo Tree" analogy, and I use it often because I think it is such a good analogy for my life: When planted

the tree can take more than five years just to break the surface of the dirt.

Overweight, and in a dark, cold place. I never stopped fighting; my roots were growing deep within, but hidden from view. I'd always say: "OK, going to lose some weight." - I tried the low carb diet for months, lost weight, then of course my hormones became damaged, and I would relapse, feel bad, and gain the weight back. It is like touching a hot stove. You get scared to do it. Afraid to put yourself out there. I became afraid of both public and personal failure. What was I to do? I was convincing myself not to care about losing the weight. I played it up, made jokes about myself. I never actually stopped trying to lose weight. I just stopped talking about it.

It was not easy to ignore my inner demons when I had no comebacks for them. The negative internal dialog always came at the hardest times, kicking me when I was down. In my head, I actually tried to convince myself that it was OK to be overweight.

"It is just the way your body is, you will always be fat, and it is what it is," - I told myself.

The inner voice kept going: "Don't put yourself out there again; it is easier just to accept being fat."

"SHUT UP! SHUT UP! SHUT THE FUCK UP!" - I started shouting at my body like it was not even a part of me anymore.

"If I have to tear this fat off with my own two hands, I swear on everything I will! Either get with me or get the hell out of my

life! I'm tired of thinking about it. I am sick of explaining myself to people, making excuses, accepting what is. Years and years I have tried, all to come to this point..."

I felt a fight-or-flight feeling rising from deep within me.

At nearly three hundred pounds with no signs of slowing, I was either going to find a way to lose the weight or jump into the abyss and never, ever return.

I scrambled and studied all of my notes I had taken since middle school, comparing what I tried and what the results were. I saw similarities in my failures - it was a process of elimination. Patterns started to emerge, and I began to see what the failures had in common. Obsession took over, relearning everything from the bottom up. It was no longer a choice I had to make, but a decision I had made. I did not tell a single soul this time - instead, I put my head down and went to work.

I figured out it did not matter what I ate, it was when I ate; mastery of meal timing followed.

So, you can say it took me twenty years to figure out a permanent solution to weight management, finally. It's just when I finally got serious about it; I grew ninety feet in a short time (Chinese Bamboo Tree analogy). It took me less than four months to lose almost hundred pounds. It is not genetics that holds us back: it is knowledge and awareness.

BAD CREDIT

The more fat-mass you add, the less your ability to have a consistent loss in weight without repercussions. Fat alters our appetite and metabolism that drive people to regain the weight, an effect that can last for years.

I can relate this to credit cards: Let's say you are fifteen thousand dollars in debt. The fees are going to start rising on you (say ten percent interest) and it rises and rises. Paying the minimum payment never lets you get out of debt. Body fat is the same problem when it correlates to health debt.

When you carry extra body fat, it is so much harder to lose that weight because fat is a stored energy source: it takes a tiny bit of energy to make it move (muscle mass, on the other hand, takes a lot more energy to move). A fit, muscular person walking a mile at the same pace as someone who is overweight will burn more calories. The deeper and deeper you get into debt, the harder it becomes to pay off; this means you have to work a lot harder for a less of return.

Real weight loss requires a long-term effort. A better understanding of how fat works, what makes it accumulate, and selecting an adaptive eating plan will work for you forever. Moreover, as you pick your weight goals, keep in mind that obesity is not good for you, but having too little body fat is not good for you either.

FINISH STRONG

The adage "it does not matter where you start, it matters where you finish" rings clear here. When I first started this weight loss journey, I was at my lowest point health-wise. I could not do one pull up, and I would get winded by walking fast up a set of stairs. My routine consisted of getting up around four am: I would eat a large breakfast (usually carbohydrate heavy) then I would sit at my desk in my condo and work from 5 a.m. until 9 p.m., only getting up to move once every hour for five minutes. During the day, I would eat whatever the hired cook made, or whatever was easy. Usually, I ordered pizza or hamburgers. Around 5 p.m. is when I usually would finish up and take a break, usually to watch a movie. Then I would come back to my desk and run simulations and study until I was tired, and finally go to bed, where I would get restless sleep.

If someone today was to send me their routine and it was a replica of mine, I would spit water out of my mouth and contact the person as soon as possible to warn them of his or her impending doom! No one, out of the five thousand plus routines I have reviewed, not one of them was as bad as my routine, and honestly, I am sure I will hold that record because I had the most dangerous routine you could imagine.

If you are in a dark place right now, I can sympathize with you. Willpower is like the wind: we cannot see it, but it's there, and

it can be powerful, or it can be next to nonexistent. You see, when you try and fail too many times, it causes deep mental anguish. Did you know hope is not free - it costs us something? When you lose weight and gain it back, there is a cost. It requires something of us to stand in a position of readiness, expecting the plan to work only to fail again, and again. When you keep wanting something that keeps eluding you, it will start to wear you down. Work for something and ending with a failed goal costs us more than somebody who wants nothing at all. That is why we have so many people who fall into the pattern of wanting absolutely nothing, and, in turn, accept obesity. Sometimes it is easier not to want anything, then to want something and not be able to get it.

It was easy for me to ignore my impending obesity because I gain weight like a bear: it's not too noticeable until I start getting obese. My neck will stay thin, but my lower back, chest, and thighs blow up. I knew I was packing on more weight than ever before, but without realizing it, I had become complacent with being unhealthy.

Since elementary school, I had weight problems.

I told you I went on the Atkins diet as a fourth grader. I was so disciplined to sticking to the diets I was on. My mom could not get me to touch a carb. Of course, this was bad because I was not getting sufficient vitamins, so she had to lie and tell me orange juice had no carbs so that I would drink it. Even after losing twenty pounds on that diet, I would eventually gain it back. This pattern

of losing weight and gaining it back was terrible, like a fat boomerang. As a kid, I had tried and failed so often with my weight loss that subconsciously I believed it was impossible.

To accommodate my repressed feelings, I would result to my naturally high confidence to help with my weight issues. I would grab a fat roll on my body and say: "I would survive longer if we were stranded on a deserted island." Or I would poke a skinny friend: "Where are your survival rations, bro?" Looking back, I realized that was me being complacent. I did not want it anymore; it was easier just not to want it.

Life has a way of moving on you. One day I took a selfie to send back home, and I realized I looked like a white Rick Ross. I was horrified. That very day I started kicking myself. "If I could not control my body, how could I control my life? How could I help guide people if I cannot guide myself?" I heard my father's words that day from all those years ago, and something in me changed. I got serious, and I did not wait around any longer: I just did it.

Part Four-Knowing the Facts

From the Garage to The Dream Gym

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I started working out at home with the bare basics, nothing fancy. Beginning with just two dumbbells, a jump rope and a copy of "T-25" (a basic workout DVD); I was just a fat guy exercising in my garage. Now, I collect rare and hard-to-find gym equipment from all over the world. With a humble start, I stumbled my way through figuring out what I know today.

It is essential to learn from the bottom up; and how to work out with few types of equipment, should you travel or have no access to a gym. I can go back to that garage with the same limitations and lose the same hundred pounds in four months.

When I shed the weight, it was not the number of pounds that blew me away, it was gaining my first six pack abs ever. For weeks, I would walk past every mirror and stop to lift my shirt. I didn't just lose weight, I surpassed all expectations and could not even believe that the reflection in the mirror was mine. The comments on my Facebook wall said it all. When I saw my mom for the first time that year at the airport, I could see the disbelief in her eyes.

Back then, I wasn't making any progress until I stopped

obsessing about my weight and started to learn from my mistakes. Every failed step brought me closer to success. With no help from anyone, I came into this thing by myself, through research and applying logic to the things I learned. I hit every bump in the road but kept pushing on, trying new things and chalking up what worked. Soon, I had a book full of what didn't work. Eventually, my own notes became my guide; the blueprints I created from my very own failure.

I noticed that whenever I started my diet after a relapse, the fat bounced off; but after few weeks of consistent dieting, the weight loss slowed and eventually halted altogether. So I researched more, not on weight loss guides, but scientific facts. It was boring, there were no pictures, and I had to Google most of the words, but I was determined to find answers. I read a lot on fat, carbs, protein and how the body reacts to them. I learned that fat exists as a source of energy and carbs as energy supplements. Then it clicked, it hit me like a bucket of cold water...

I realized that I had to gain weight to lose weight!

I went back and studied my relapses, where and when I had the most progress. I found out that the body must THINK it has unlimited energy. The body must believe that CARBS are the primary source of energy and not fat. We do not want the body to think that fat is its main source of fuel; then it uses it sparingly.

I knew I had to ditch my fear of gaining weight because it was prohibiting me from actually losing weight. Fear was holding me back.

"Weight loss is three leaps forward and two steps backward." I realized that it was not a sprint, but a car race, and I would often need a pit stop. It did not matter how many times I worked out, or how many calories I consumed daily; the only thing that mattered was I had to gain weight to lose weight. It countered all common knowledge, but I wouldn't let that stop me.

My set back was a set up for my come back, like a sling shot!

My experiences flowed out of me and connected all the dots. What I learned was to shock the body by eating carbs for an extended period of time to convince it that it has an unlimited supply of power. The shock should be over the average amount body has to process these carbs in some form or another. When there is an extreme amount of carbs entering the body, the metabolism ramps up. This is good because if the body thinks it has an unlimited supply of energy, then it will use the highest amount of energy it can to perform as exceptional as possible so you can produce the best offspring. We're always tricking it into burning the maximum amount of fat possible. By doing this, we also receive the most energy possible.

THE BODY GOES ALL-IN

When I found out what worked, I never stopped pushing. I learned what works for weight loss and I took it to the extreme~~s~~. I went to the edge of the cliff and jumped off. I marked where the edge was and kept falling off, pushing to see where the abyss really was. I know where it is now and what to look for when approaching it. I keep

at the edge and take the smaller inch steps, an inch here, a centimeter there, to see if my body can adapt and force the abyss to move back more.

I learned that the body does not settle, it goes the optimal route and rises to the top. If it has unlimited energy, it will use the most it can, so we trick the body into thinking this. Then we flip the switch! The body still THINKS it has unlimited energy, so it burns the fat as if it has infinite energy.

Imagine Mike Tyson punching a wall of semi-wet clay. His fist would hit the wall at top speed and stay at high speed until it eventually started to slow and ultimately stops. We are trying to have Mike hit with the other hand as we pull back our main hand. There is never a lull, always burning fat at top speed. RIGHT before it gets suspicious of what's going on, we hit it with an extreme amount of carbs (Mike's fist). It then goes into shock, like a reflex it can't control. This ramps up the metabolism to as high as it can go, using the maximum amount of energy it can.

When we get a large influx of carbs, the body is "shocked" and goes into flight or fight mode; it ramps up everything! Creativity, concentration, metabolism, you name it everything gets a boost; it will use as much energy as supplied. It's fast to use fast acting carbohydrates as fuel rather than metabolize them into glucose to then convert to fatty tissue and stuff inside a cell. This is why it's important to get enough carbohydrates at the right times to

maximize on this instinctual effect.

However, our body is far from dumb. Even if it gets plenty of carbs, but not enough for it to be shocked, then it will know fat is the primary fuel, and it knows exactly how much fat it has in the tank. When shocked with carbs, however, it goes into a primitive mode, where it burns as fast as it can just to handle the overload of sugar. It's not so smart however to catch on to the switch from carbs to fats immediately and still stays in rampant state. To do this, you must eat a surplus of carbs for an extended period to convince the body that carbs are the reserve and that it has unlimited amounts of energy. The body eventually catches on to even this, and we have to shock it differently.

Why Ketosis is Overly Used

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Once the body hasn't produced any excess fat in a long time, regardless, it will catch on. The only way is to shock the system by eating excess carbs and gaining some fat strategically. This is the reason people who use ketosis to lose weight usually end up gaining the weight back. I know; on paper it makes sense, right? Cut out the carbohydrates, and the body is forced to burn fat as fuel. What’s going on behind the scenes when people deprive their bodies of carbs for too long? Leptin, ghrelin, and testosterone--arguably the three most important hormones when it comes to weight loss--and muscle building sink dramatically. Once sunken for a long time, the harder it becomes to regulate our hormones.

Another reason prolonged ketosis diets are very harmful is that once the body realizes it has no outside source of energy, it goes into lock-down mode; the fat cells hold on to more fat and burn it less frequently. Your hunger levels shoot through the roof after an extended period without carbs; this is a primal defense mechanism to keep you alert and always looking for food. Also, when the body realizes fat is its primary or only source of energy, the body drives energy usage way down. The body cuts energy for all things, like creativity, concentration, and metabolism to name the top sectors that get hit first. The body doesn't give a shit about your work or personal life; the body solely cares about having enough energy to

digest food, to intake vitamin D from the sun, and absorb oxygen from trees/plants. As far as your work project that's due Monday, yeah, the body isn't so concerned with that. Sleep? Hell yeah! Why not? We must preserve our energy stores; we only have X percent of fat left in our tank! I hope you're starting to realize how important carbohydrates are for our overall well-being when timed right.

Low carbohydrates combined with low calories leads to drastically lower leptin levels, when compared to a reasonable caloric deficit. As levels of leptin begin to decline more and more, the hunger levels humans experience will raise in parallel. Leptin also affects our muscles and thyroid hormones, and decreased quantities of it will stall our metabolism. All of this contributes to lower leptin levels, causing weight gain. It also affects adiponectin, which sends glucose levels out of whack as well as fatty acid breakdown. Another hormone affected is ghrelin by decreasing HGH output and increasing appetite artificially.

THE BREAKDOWN OF SUGARS

Now let's talk about taking advantage of the different types of sugars, and also when to eat them. As I'll cover extensively in this book, carbohydrates are usually taken after workouts, if it's not a particular strategic day, like a refeed day. When talking about carb timing, it's important to know what types of sugars there are, and what they do.

Sugars are carbohydrates, and their primary role in the body

is to produce energy for cells. Blood sugar levels refer to the amount of glucose in the blood.

There are three types of sugars: monosaccharides, oligosaccharides, and polysaccharides.

Monosaccharides are often called simple sugars because they have a very simple composition. There are three different kinds of monosaccharides: glucose, fructose, and galactose glucose. Galactose glucose, also known as blood sugar, is of course found in the blood, and produced from the food we consume. Galactose is mostly found in foods from dietary carbohydrates and consists of glucose either as the sole form of sugar or in combination with fructose. Fructose is a type of sugar naturally found in fruit. It is also found in processed products like sucrose (table sugar) and high-fructose corn syrup (HFCS), both of which are about half fructose and half glucose. Galactose is a type of sugar found in most dairy products and is metabolized similarly to fructose.

Oligosaccharides are molecules that consist of chains of monosaccharides. These sugars are one of the components of plant fiber, which our bodies partially break down into glucose, leaving behind the indigestible fiber that improves stomach health. Most vegetables contain fructooligosaccharides, which are small chains of fructose particles. After oligosaccharide chains break down, the individual fructose molecules are converted into glucose to be utilized as energy by the body. Raffinose is another type of

oligosaccharide that we commonly eat; it is comprised of chains of galactose and called a trisaccharide. Trisaccharides are found in foods like asparagus, beans, broccoli, and cabbage. Galactooligosaccharides are short chains of galactose molecules that are indigestible but stimulate beneficial bacterial growth in the stomach.

Polysaccharides are long chains of monosaccharides, usually containing ten or more units. Two examples of polysaccharides that we eat are starch, which stores energy in plants, and cellulose, which is a natural plant fiber. The body can quickly break down starches into glucose. In contrast, cellulose is not broken down; it passes through the digestive system intact, acting as a source of dietary fiber.

High-fructose corn syrup (HFCS) is **artificial** (not found in nature). The difference between HFCS and sucrose is that in HFCS the fructose and glucose are not chemically bonded together, which means the body has to do less work to metabolize it into glucose. HFCS is chemically very similar to sucrose; they are just a source of glucose for the body like any other carbohydrate. HFCS can be beneficial to helping muscles recover faster when its ingestion is timed correctly. During high-intensity exercise, you use up the store of glycogen in your muscles. If it isn't replenished with fast-acting carbohydrates soon after a workout, your workouts in the coming days might suffer. Fast-acting carbohydrates have a bad reputation because they are

associated with junk foods like candy and soda, but they help enhance muscle recovery.

All forms of carbohydrate that we eat, including all of these sugars, are either metabolized into glucose or are left undigested as dietary fiber. The body can't differentiate between the natural sugar found in fruit, honey or milk and the processed sugar found in delicious desserts. They're all digested in the same way: broken down into monosaccharides, which transform into glucose to be directed to the brain, muscles and internal organs. In the end, the dessert turns into glucose just like a cup of broccoli does; while the former will become glucose faster than the latter, that's it. The difference is that the rich desert has a lot of monosaccharides that metabolize quickly, whereas the broccoli contains oligosaccharides that take longer.

HEALTHY RELATIONSHIP WITH SUGAR

The problem is not sugar, or any other macro nutrition. The problem is overeating. People are feeding their bodies more energy than it needs every day, especially in civilized areas. If you give your body a lot more energy than it needs every day, whether, from excess amounts of protein, carbohydrate, or dietary fat, you will gain weight. And this is where we get to the actual problem with sugar intake and getting or staying overweight: the more you eat foods with added sugars, the easier it is to overeat. The effects of these simple sugars vary widely among individuals based on weight, age, sex, and

activity level. Overweight, sedentary bodies don't deal with simple sugars nearly as well as lean, physically active ones do.

Furthermore, when you mix carbohydrates in all forms with other types, the insulin response is heightened. Eating a couple of tablespoons of sucrose on an empty stomach causes a greater insulin response in the body than eating a couple of tablespoons of sucrose as a part of a mixed meal. Even in the circumstances of a mixed meal, simple sugars still do raise insulin levels greater than complex carbs, like the polysaccharides found in vegetables. From this knowledge we can suggest some sensible advice: if you're overweight and don't exercise, you shouldn't be eating a lot of simple sugars every day. You will be harming your health. On the other hand, if you work out regularly and aren't overweight, your body can deal with simple sugars just fine if timed right. You're not going to risk your health by eating sugars. One other health-related anxiety is the fact that eating a lot of foods with added sugars can decrease the number of micronutrients the body causing a nutrient deficiency. Many foods with the added sugars in them don't have many essential vitamins and minerals. This is why it is important to get the majority of daily calories from healthier, nutrient-dense foods, and supplement with a known quality multivitamin. We can't fear any macronutrient, every "bad" carb has its place, and it can be just as useful as any other macronutrient end as long as it is timed right.

Correct Carbohydrate Timing

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An example of bad timing would be spiking insulin first thing in the morning by eating carbs right after waking up. This problem can be compounded by spiking insulin at night and then doing so again first thing in the morning with breakfast. These people are never giving their bodies the adequate HGH that it needs to function optimally.

When we were hunter-gatherers, carbs were consumed primarily around hunting time to replenish energy. The body is used to going without food for long stretches, which significantly increases HGH production. When we spike our insulin at night and in the morning, we blunt the production of HGH, which leads to problems like early balding, excess fat, depression, flaky skin, poor vision and more. Without proper HGH levels in the body, we hinder our ability to grow new cells and burn fat.

Another reason to avoid early insulin spikes is that a crash always follows six hours later. Most people work full-time jobs and have other responsibilities; they can't afford to be left with no energy in the middle of the day. Therefore, in an effort to stay awake, they will eat more fast acting carbohydrates, or resort to stimulants like caffeine. The core problem, however, is consuming carbs first thing in the morning. This sets off a vicious cycle of insulin spikes and crashes that can lead to insulin resistance, and in turn to

diabetes.

Your adrenaline gland will also become resistant to caffeine, reducing the effects of both carbs and caffeine; as a result, you start to feel tired even after ingesting both food and caffeine. The more frequently we rely on these quick fixes, the more insulin resistant we become, and the less useful the stimulants become.

People hear the word “carbs”, and think of bad things like diabetes. But the truth is that carbohydrates increase our most powerful hormone, insulin, which can be made to work for us rather than against us. Think of carbs as being like a fire. Fire is not intrinsically bad, and if used in the right way can be very beneficial. Lighting a fireplace to have it warm our homes and cook our food--this would be an analogy for proper carb timing. Taking fire from the fireplace and putting it on the living room rug, causing a house fire--this is an analogy for bad carb timing, like eating carbs right when you wake up.

Another case of bad carbohydrate timing is consuming them at night, as mentioned earlier. Human Growth Hormone (HGH) discharges in a pulsating manner following our natural 24-hour circadian rhythm. Its biggest release is when you sleep, it releases throughout your sleep cycle in spurts, and the first release is the biggest one.

Spiking insulin by eating carbohydrates right before sleep drastically lowers this initial HGH pulse, which has been shown to be essential for lipolysis the next day. Lipolysis, the breakdown

of lipids and hydrolysis of triglycerides into glycerol and free fatty acids; it is what "fat burning" refers to. There is a delayed effect when it comes to HGH and lipolysis: the more growth hormone that is released, the more fat that will burn throughout the night. If insulin is spiked dramatically right before sleeping, this suppresses the biggest release of HGH, and in turn, reduces lipolysis. If this is done every night, the reduction over time is substantial; to avoid this, it is best to stop eating carbs four hours before sleep.

One test has shown that when adults with HGH deficiency resulting from pituitary disease supplemented their diet with an HGH replacement, it improved their body composition, increasing both bone mass and lean muscle mass while decreasing fat stores! This replacement simply brought their levels to what is average for their respective ages. Note that I only believe in increasing HGH **naturally**, never through supplements or injections that can cause severe health issues.

On average, a dormant person burns about 0.42 calories per pound of LBM in one hour of sleep. For example, a hundred-pound person burns about forty-two calories in one hour. With lower insulin levels before sleep, we can raise this number higher; this also maximizes our lipolysis results for the following day, as stated above.

To capitalize on all forms of carbohydrates, I like to eat an apple after a workout, and add a banana to my shake. This allows me

to replenish both muscle and liver glycogen, the forgotten hero. But while we need our post-workout carbs, there's a limit. Remember, muscles are like sponges; eventually, they can't absorb any more. There are diminishing returns, and at a certain point, more carbs do not further stimulate glycogen resynthesis. Our goal is to thoroughly saturate the "sponge" without excess spilling over.

At a particular level, the stomach reaches its maximum rate of carb absorption, and extra carbs accumulate in the gut and turn to fat if not used as fuel within twelve to sixteen hours. However, fructose is absorbed via a different route in the stomach than most of the other carbohydrates. This means that carb absorption would be higher with a glucose/fructose mix than one with glucose alone. This increased rate of absorption also provides more carbs to the muscle for glycogen resynthesis. The combination of carbs I've found is a two to one ratio of glucose to fructose mix.

THE FORGOTTEN HERO

When talking about weight loss, and replenish glycogen, most people picture fat or muscles. Words like, metabolism, and lipolysis come to mind. The automation of counting calories and tracking macros pops into our thoughts. However, what if I told you that behind the scenes were an organ that was running the show. That's right, worrying too much about muscles and fat and neglecting to aid in the health of this organ can be your great downfall. Without further ado, we pay our respects to. . . The **LIVER!**

The liver creates fat-derived energy called "ketone bodies." Once created, ketone bodies enter the bloodstream to be used by various important organs, like the brain. Ketone bodies are especially critical to the brain because the mind has no other abundant non-glucose-derived energy source. Keep in mind that ketones are forever present in the bloodstream, and their levels will increase during fasting and lengthened physical activity.

The two most important ketone bodies are acetoacetate (AcAc), and 3-hydroxybutyrate (3HB). These two governing ketone bodies are energy-rich compounds that are essential for transporting energy from the liver to other body tissues.

Ketone body metabolism comprises ketone body synthesis, aka **ketogenesis**, and the breakdown of ketones. During the phase in which the body goes from being in a fed state to a fasted state, the liver transitions from an organ of carbohydrate utilization and fatty acid synthesis, to a fatty acid oxidation and ketone body manufacturer.

During fasting, the body incurs high levels of glucagon and low levels of insulin which support ketogenesis throughout the development of lipolysis in the adipocyte and the stimulation of fatty-acid-oxidation in the liver.

After an over-night fast, ketone bodies supply around five percent of the body's energy requirements. After a twenty hour fast, ketone bodies supply roughly up to twenty percent of the energy needs! The occupancy of high ketone bodies in the blood is titled ketosis.

Ketone bodies perform a significant role in sparing glucose utilization and decreasing proteolysis. Unlike most other tissues, the brain cannot use fatty acids for energy when blood glucose levels become jeopardized. In this case, ketone bodies present the mind with another source of energy, accumulating to nearly two-thirds of the brain's energy requirements through phases of an extended fast!

When insulin is high, it blunts the breakdown of triglycerides to fatty acids and glycerol. It does it by hindering the breakdown of triglycerides by limiting the amount fatty acids transported for oxidation and ketone body creation.

While fasting, the liver's glycogen stores drain quickly. The liver prefers fructose when its glycogen stores deplete. Keeping the liver in top shape is ideal if quality for excellent health. One huge reason is that the liver makes cholesterol, improving overall heart health.

The liver continually oxidizes triglycerides to produce energy. The liver breaks down fatty acids and relocates mass quantities of acetoacetate, dumping it into the bloodstream where other tissues can metabolize it. **A healthy liver will aid in significant fat loss!**

The liver is also responsible for the removal of ammonia from our body by "synthesis of urea." Ammonia is highly toxic, and if not readily and efficiently removed from circulation, it'll make the central nervous system (CNS) shut down.

The liver is the key place for transforming the spillover of

macronutrients into fatty acids and triglycerides, which are then relocated and properly stored. The more efficient this conversion of macro spillover goes over, the faster the metabolism can work and thus the faster the fat burns.

Deamination and transamination of essential amino acids (histidine, isoleucine, leucine, lysine, methionine, phenylalanine, threonine, tryptophan, and valine) result in the conversion of the non-nitrogenous part of those acids to glucose or lipids. The synthesis of nonessential amino acids (alanine, arginine, asparagine, aspartate, cysteine, glutamate, glutamine, glycine, proline, serine, and tyrosine) and lipoproteins, is handled in the liver, which helps nourish the body more quickly. The liver synthesizes several of the clotting agents required for blood coagulation, commencing to accelerated nutrient distribution.

When glycogen stores deplete, the liver energizes synthesizing enzymes that separate glucose from amino acids and carbohydrates. With the liver's support during times, of low glycogen stores, it prevents the body from shutting down and enables the HGH to aid and fix the body.

Part Five-Feast & Famine

Balance is Essential

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Insulin is very powerful, it's like a double-edged sword, and when used incorrectly it will cut us instead of the fat. Insulin is anabolic and will spur muscle growth and cell reproduction. The other side of this blade is it also encourages the growth of any kind, including fat while blunting the production of our beloved hormone HGH. The body cannot burn fat while insulin levels are high. Fat is an emergency fuel, only used when it is absolute needed. What we see as ugly superficial excess skin, the body sees as lifesaving fuel that is absolutely required to survive. Outsmarting our bodies is not the easiest thing to do. The trick here is to make the body believe that it needs to burn this precious fuel (fat) because it is under stress.

Just like with anything, there must be a balance. Using insulin spikes at the right time is great, post workout for example. If we spike our insulin in the morning regularly, then it's bad. I explained why going low carb for too long is bad, I did not explain to a large degree the benefits and timing of carb intake. Going a few weeks may not stunt creativity, but there are people to where ketosis is a lifestyle, and they go months even years without eating carbs (I know

people who've done this, including me), and this is where the real damage occurs. You most likely won't hurt your hormones after a week of no carbs, but a few months, yes you will be running a high risk. With proper meal timing comes the best of both worlds, combine with intermittent fasting and we can regulate our insulin levels, use the insulin at the right times to build muscle and go into ketosis when we want to burn fat, but do this in a responsible manner. We now know that going low carb for too long makes the body realize that fat is its primary currency and not carbs, and our metabolism will slow; for some, it will slow more than others based on weight, age & sex.

FEAST OR FAMINE

However, now that we know the power of carbohydrates, the problem is today's society have food at the tips of their fingers, waking up eating large amounts of calories meals every day. Never in our history have we had instant access to such calorie-rich foods. Our hunter-gatherer ancestors didn't have the luxury of eating five meals a day. For our forefathers, it was feast or famine. Our very existence as a species is because humans were able to survive extended periods without food. It's obvious that we adopted our ancestors eating patterns that were very sporadic, leading to their bodies having to adapt to all kinds of different situations. That is why we produce HGH to regulate the body. This hormone is produced when we are hungry and stressed as a defense mechanism that allowed us to survive until today. It is known that when we eat, we blunt the

production of this hormone. If you eat in the morning all day until night, every day, you can see that this is not natural. We are built for stress, and without it, we never benefit from our most powerful hormones. It's like keeping a Ferrari in the parking lot forever.

Bear in mind the body is not meant to lose fat.

People with higher metabolisms can manage weight better. Some people are born bigger and develop more muscle mass quicker and easier than others. Some kids exercised or played sports at a very young age when others didn't.

Eating with sporadic timing, and no set meal window is not a good way to live. When our body is fed every two to three hours, it will burn fuel from those meals, rather than from its fat stores. So instead of burning stored fat between meals the way we're designed, our body enjoys having meals delivered every two to three hours. Even when tricked into thinking carbs are the main supply, fat will still be active fuel supply while fasting. When the body burns the far between meals for food, you will feel more energy, stable moods, clarity of mind, deeper sleep, fewer cravings and natural and permanent weight management.

Think of how easy it is to overeat; you have egg & bacon with toast for breakfast. A snack for brunch. For lunch, you have a sandwich & salad. A few hours later another snack. Just after noon and you've consumed 1500 calories already. You then have a mid-day snack, and then dinner… maybe a late-night snack. This leads to

overeating and massive weight gains.

TOO MUCH SOLID FOOD CREATES BACKLOG

People fail to realize that it costs vital energy every meal we consume. The most energy consuming function our body does is digesting food. Even more, than exercise, respiration, circulation, thinking, etc. This energy is vital for our workouts and critical thinking skills. We don't realize how much energy we waste until we actually fast. People argue that eating nets them more energy throughout the day. It makes sense on paper right. "I'm digesting a big solid meal. Therefore, I'm burning more calories, right?" Now, you have to look at your energy, your energy is precious! People fail to realize, to burn fat, it cost energy. For the metabolism to be ramped up, in needs to expend lots of energy, if the energy isn't there, it will slow down. So, the more energy you have the most fat you're going to be able to burn.

Now you are starting to understand that if you're eating big solid meals all day, it's going to expend more energy than anything you could do. All your hard-earned energy will be going towards digestion. That's why you hear most people complain about fatigue after eating a big meal, especially when they are in a fasted state. You're not going to have extra energy for your metabolism. Your muscle repair will be slower. Your energy use on digesting could have gone to muscle repair, which leads to greater fat loss via the more intense of the repair. But, it goes deeper than that. If you have a big solid

meal before your workout, that's going to sap a lot of your energy, and your workouts are going to suffer. It's also going to slow down muscle repair. Because if you're too busy digesting food, it's like traffic. You'll create this long line of traffic for when the carbs, proteins, and nutrients need to get to your muscles post workout. Another big thing about this, it's going to slow muscle repair that next day as well. Your body will be focusing more on digesting food then repairing muscle tissue. That's why I recommend liquid meals. They are very easy to digest, so you don't get the fatigue that comes with solid meals. Repairing the muscle, keep in mind, burns calories. If done correctly, it will burn a lot of calories. Burning calories just for the sake of burning calories is not the correct mindset. That's like trying to throw money at a problem and just keep throwing money, throwing money, but problems aren't solved with money, they're solved with proper execution. No amount of money will make a plant grow in the dark, but you put the plant in the sun, it will grow for free.

Also, keep in mind that liquid is typically going to be fewer calories than a solid meal. It's going to be more calories to get a big solid 50-grams of protein using solid foods, usually 400-500 calories on the lower end. You can get that amount of protein for half the calories than a solid meal without the extra, bad stress being put on your body via constant digestion. Some things can affect human growth hormone output. Well, our Insulin will be low in the

morning. And our cortisol will be high in the morning. Great right? Not so fast... (No pun intended) While food is absorbing, our cortisol will be attacking the food for digestion (wasting more energy) instead of our triglyceride levels and our HGH will be stunted. (Not as much as when insulin is high, insulin is the shutoff valve for HGH, this will blunt it about 30-60%) Digesting solid meals, more than three a day will lead to a backlog. This means you'll be in a constant state of digestion. It can take 24 to 72 hours for complete digestion of food! From the time you take your first bite until the food waste is excreted from your body. You can bet that a fatty meal will fully digest in like 72 hours rather 24 hours. This has so many ill effects on our body. On top of causing cancer, stress, fatigue, and even depression, digesting food around the clock is never a good thing.

To combat backlog and terrible food timing, it's good to get a good base of when to eat the majority of our calories. The underlying object is quite simple, ninety percent of the time we are burning calories with fasting and low-calorie meals, and getting the bulk of the calories around workout time. This is the gain fat to lose fat principle; it's about strategic under eating and over eating timing. If you work out late at night while keeping calories and carbohydrates very low all day, you burn fat all day, then eat a surplus of calories after your late workout. This gives the body the extra calories to repair the torn muscles at the right time.

Nutrient Body Breakdown

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Talking about what nutrients the body uses and the timing, let's talk about how the body breakdowns nutrients. The timing and process of breaking down foods is an important part to know for understanding how to properly time your meals. The liver transforms amino acids into readily usable molecules in a system called deamination. Deamination converts amino acids to nitrogen and then turns nitrogen into ammonia, which is relocated via the liver and excreted in urine. The three energy sources for Animals: Amino Acids, Sugars & Fatty Acids. Charged molecules are Amino acids & sugars. Charged particles draw a significant amount of water into cells.

Fun Fact: Soap is derived from fatty acids. If you've seen the movie "Fight Club," you know the dumpster scene.

The body doesn't want fatty soap like acids floating around obviously, so the solution is to store them as triglycerides. In this triglyceride form, the fat draws tiny amounts water, and this allows the body to store an enormous amount of fat in each cell. Just like with free floating fatty acids, we can transform sugars into glycogen the same way. Glucose is a precursor of glycogen and draws less water compared to glucose molecules. The body compresses these molecules and stores them, like a computer "zipping" a file. The body can only hold so many "charged" particles until it ruptures. Amino acids are charged particles; charged particles draw a lot more water into a

cell compared to sugars and fat. To neutralize the charge, we can form a polymer of amino acids; the only way the body can store extra amino acids is in the shape of protein molecules.

Every life form we know of has thousands of various proteins in them. However, with protein molecules there isn't a single form it's stored in, and there is a good reason for that: Carbohydrates and fats are chemically somewhat dormant, proteins aren't. All protein has a job. Therefore, it's hard to clarify what excess protein means. Many amino acids are easy to make, and most don't cost much to do so, so the body would rather use these than store them. If excess proteins are floating around, the body will put them to good use, and that's not always for building muscles. Amino acid availability mostly controls protein synthesis; in a well-nourished state the body will absorb and produce more proteins at a higher rate than usual. Combine with being in a fasted state when taking the protein in, most cells in the body will dismantle phagocytosis (they will digest large portions of the proteins into the cell and releases amino acids for new protein synthesis.) When we digest protein, the stomach uses enzymes and acids to break it down into amino acids. The Protease enzymes break down proteins into Peptides, while Peptidase enzymes break down tinier forms of proteins into amino acids. These macro-nutrients relocate to the bloodstream and then delivered to various parts of the body. The small intestine only has so many transporter cells, which limits the number of amino acids that can

be infused into the blood every hour. Proper macro timing comes into play now as we can get even more out of our protein absorption. Protein absorption: How quickly our small intestine can absorb amino acids into our blood. Rough estimates: Whey Protein takes eight to ten grams per hour to digest. Casein Protein takes five to six grams per hour to digest. Soy Protein takes three to four grams per hour to digest. Egg Protein takes two to four grams per hour to digest. These can always change based on the quality and pureness of the protein absorbed. Certain proteins digest very slowly, and others process relatively fast.

Think of the muscle like a sponge. A good sponge is the one that can be thoroughly dried without becoming hard. Similar to pouring water on a sponge and it becoming saturated to the point that it can no longer absorb any water; the muscles are the same way with absorbing nutrients until fully saturated. Ways to dry out the "sponge" (muscles) are Fasting. Workouts. Low carbohydrates. Because of the sponge-like nature of muscles, if all the protein comes in at the same time, or in a few big meals, this will lead to a large spillover. This "spillover" in laymen's terms means: Broken down amino acids wanted for muscle growth become utilized for other processes unrelated to fat loss or building lean mass. The muscles will absorb more nutrients, essential glucose when the sponge it's dry so to speak. Pour just enough nutrients on the muscles to have them fully saturated; then let them dry, and rinse & repeat.

Given the speed at which Whey protein absorbs (eight to ten grams per hour), it's safe to assume that one could absorb up to fifteen grams per hour when in a fasted state. Meaning: Protein intake around fifty grams every three hours AFTER breaking fast will maximize protein synthesis by directing the most protein per hour towards muscle growth. Three hours after taking fifty grams of protein, the person will return to the fasted state, therefore getting the heightened absorption rate every time. Eating eight meals a day forces the body to absorb all of those nutrients, tons of protein; this creates the backlog, which means that rotting food will be sitting in the intestines collecting parasites. A steak dinner can take forty to seventy or more hours to fully digest; based off someone who eats on an empty stomach. Eating a steak while backlogged, this meat can sit inside the stomach rotting for well over eighty or more hours.

CREATURES LIVING INSIDE YOU

Every living being has parasites and bacteria living inside, some worse than others. One can live an entire life with tapeworms and not realize it. The backlog is obviously not okay for a lot of reasons, but these parasites live off the food you eat and your flesh. The more rotting food in the stomach, the bigger the parasites grow and the more they multiply. The more parasites you have, the more these creatures will steal your nourishment and cause infections leading to health issues and slower muscle gains and in some cases

can lead to muscle loss.

Being backlogged with rotting food is the perfect breeding grounds for parasites and bacteria. There is a smart way to body build, and a dumb brute force way to body build. Yes, one can build muscle eating eight meals a day, but at what cost to personal health? The body doesn't need three hundred grams of protein a day to build muscle; this is overkill and bad for people's health! With intermittent fasting people don't need to eat as much protein because of heightened human growth hormone levels. Intermittent fasting promotes natural human growth hormone levels to over one thousand percent as you already know.

The truth is, the longer we feed, the lazier our metabolism becomes. But fit our food intake into a timed window, and our body steps up, burning more calories day and night. Our body absorbs the food more efficiently. Fasting causes hunger or stress. In response, our body produces HGH and releases more cholesterol, allowing it to utilize fat as a source of fuel, instead of glucose. This decreases the amount of fat in each cell in the body. This is important because the less amount of fat in the cells, the less likely it will experience insulin resistance or diabetes.

To counter this, strategic fasting will normalize our insulin and leptin sensitivity, which is key for optimal health as insulin resistance (which is what we get when our insulin sensitivity plummets) is a primary contributing factor to nearly all chronic

disease, from diabetes to heart disease and even cancer.

Water, Please

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Most people would be considered "clinically dehydrated." People simply don't drink enough water. You can get the best-detailed map drawn up, but if you don't know how the body works and the necessary steps to get started, you'll never win. The whole process always does and always will start with the first hour of the day.

<u>The very first hour after you wake up will make or break your day!</u>

If you don't get your one liter of water in that hour, you're screwed when it comes to cravings. When you don't drink enough water, your body receives mixed signals on thirst & hunger. Dehydration causes artificial food cravings leading you to believe you're hungry when actually, thirst is the only issue. The mixed signals on thirst and hunger are primal, as you can't smell or taste water, so the body forces you to crave things you can smell, like food. In hunter-gather times, when you smelled food, a water source was usually nearby.

This natural instinct is why you can eat, and not feel full if you're even somewhat dehydrated. The body forces you to crave food, in hopes you'll find a water supply. Not quenching the bodies thirst will lead to never ending cravings, no matter how much you eat. Keep in mind everyone is dehydrated when first waking up!

Missing the first drink of the day, this causes one to play "catch up" in that, you'll always be behind without any way of

catching up. It's not like you're going to drink two liters in one setting to catch up, and I wouldn't advise that anyway. So, missing that first liter of the day will put you in a bind. Not drinking this water will certainly guarantee you "hunger" pains later in the day.

We live in a society where we can smell a Mc Donald's a mile away, and the sense of smell activates appetite, which is enhanced greatly by dehydration; this means double damage if you neglect to intake liquid early. It's funny, the easiest thing to do is drink a tall glass of fresh, clean water. Most people ignore this step and when I hear: "I get hungry by noon" - I rather hear nails on a chalkboard because nine times out of ten, the issue is missing that first drink of the day.

Water should be our first meal of the day, people say to eat a big solid breakfast, for example, this one I have a personal issue with because this was forced down our throat as children. Most of us didn't even have a choice. Breakfast is maybe one of the most destructive habits you can form because it is so misguided.

It reminds me of a story I've read when doctors use to prescribe nicotine cigarettes for a sore throat in the 1960's. Health professionals telling obese people to eat breakfast to help them lose weight. With the obvious obesity problem we face today, I think it's pretty obvious that we need to rethink our game plan when it comes to health. This is so painfully obvious. You simply can't make money from fasting. There is NO money in not eating in the morning. There

is no fasting pill you can sell. That's why it's not advertised on TV. When I switched to having plenty of water in the morning, my health improved so drastically, it was incredible.

THE VICIOUS CIRCLE

Let's see if this sounds familiar. You go to bed eating a snack (spikes insulin, depletes water via digestion). You wake up and have coffee (dehydrates you even more because of the caffeine). Keep in mind you're in a fasted state. Sleeping is a fast and upon waking up, no matter how much water you had the day before you will still be dehydrated. After that, you eat breakfast because your stomach hurts because you've mistaken hunger cravings for dehydration. Eating halts the fat burning process and dehydrates people even more. By now you're clinically dehydrated, you're tired, hungry, depressed, experiencing pains in your stomach even though you just ate an hour ago... confusing them for hunger pains, you eat another snack. You have an energy drink for a boost (full of caffeine dehydrating more). You're lucky if you get 2 liters a day of water. The cycle continues as you drink just enough water to get by to continue the vicious circle. The body’s need for water is both underrated, and under-respected.

Of all the routines I've gone through, this is in 90% of the people; they don't drink near enough pure water. The more water you drink, the less water you retain.

FLUSH MODE

When the body has plenty of water, it'll utilize it efficiently, flushing the body and greatly promoting new cell growth. Your body will utilize more water, without actually holding onto it. In reality, at a snapshot, the body would have more water inside of it while raining very little of it. The constant flowing of water achieves this. Retaining too much water due to lack of proper hydration blunts new cell growth, and inhibits muscle gains.

If you're not getting enough water, your body will reuse old water. This water is riddled with toxins from purifying the cells the first time. Basically, it turns into stagnant water when we want fresh water. Once in this flush mode, you're able to handle more water than you normally would be able to if your body were retaining the water.

Simple solution: Drink 3-6+ liters of water a day with the first two liters drunk in the first hour of waking. Gauge this based on weight, if you're smaller, drink less. Do not eat breakfast. When you eat breakfast early, have a low carb, high protein shakes with an omega 3 source. If you must eat, have a meal with low carb high protein or fat. Also, do not eat carbs before sleeping.

My personal side note on this.

When this happened to me, I made the mistake of thinking the hunger was caused by overactive acid in my stomach causing the stomach pains. I took anti-acids; this maybe the worst thing you can do

because nine times out of ten, the discomfort is caused by dehydration. If you take anti-acids for the reason I stated, I suggest drinking more water, and try to wean off the anti-acids. If you decide that you need them, and you're wrong, and it is dehydration, this will lead to what was maybe an average acid level, being blunted to be below normal. This will result in food not being digested properly, nutrients not being broken down correctly. This can lead to health issues and weight gain.

The Thief in the Night

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One of my newer clients has been my hardest case yet. This individual was low carbohydrate for as long as he could remember. On top of that, he had just ended a three-day fast! Needless to say, I have/had my work cut out for me... We tried a lot of different methods, to isolate the problem. Once we fixed the core issues, there was this lingering answer that I couldn't quite put my finger on it. It finally came down to stress being one of the biggest concerns.

Periods of prolonged chronic stress increases both cortisol & insulin levels, and in combination, this will send a strong signal to fat cells to store as much fatty tissue as possible. This "fat" signal tells cells to hold on to their fat stores while the stress can prevent the ability of our body to release fat from its stores. Cortisol & epinephrine are adrenal stress hormones. Because chronic stress responses activate the sympathetic nervous system and stimulation of epinephrine and cortisol release. These hormones over long periods of time can lead to greater levels of insulin resistance. Cortisol does increase our metabolism, but it also increases hunger cravings.

So, while our body may be burning more calories when we're stressed, we eat more anyway. The cortisol increases oil concentrates in skin. Stress reduction is critical to successfully treating skin ailments and promoting healthy skin cell growth and regeneration.

As we enter a deep meditative state, the body switches to a healing mode; which enhances the body's capacity to self-heal and function optimally.

In healthy individuals, mental stress increases heart rate but simultaneously decreases vascular resistance in skeletal muscle. This results in a moderate increase in blood pressure, and an acute increase in insulin-mediated glucose disposal. In obese patients, mental stress elicits responses which differ widely from those of healthy individuals.

While mental stress enhances catecholamine-mediated energy expenditure in obese patients to the same extent as in lean subjects, it fails to decrease systemic vascular resistance due to endothelial dysfunction. This leads to enhanced blood pressure responses and the absence of stimulation of glucose disposal in obese subjects during mental stress.

It can be hypothesized that repeated professional or social stress may activate the sympathoadrenal system, resulting in high cortisol levels, stimulation of the sympathetic nervous system, and epinephrine secretion. All these factors may eventually lead to the development of central obesity and insulin resistance.

Insulin is the hormone that is responsible for storing fatty tissue in the fat cells called the adipose tissue. Insulin transforms sugar stored in our liver & muscle cells into glycogen while absorbing amino acids as a by-product of protein synthesis. Because of its

versatility, insulin can be thought of as a storage hormone in that it helps our body put all these various energy sources and translocate them into their rightful place and stored for later use.

However, the opposite of insulin's versatility happens when our body experiences a stress response, and our heart & muscles are in dire need of quick energy. Think of fat as a slower-burning fuel and muscles as a faster-burning fuel. Our body will use either of the two given the situation. If it's in a bind, bye-bye muscle tissue; if it's relaxed, it will burn fat. Stress can artificially cause muscle loss simply from increased heart rate. The body produces cortisol during periods of excess stress. Significant amounts of cortisol will slow down the responsiveness of cells to the storage effects of insulin. Making our cells ignore insulin too often can lead to insulin resistance and eventually will cause diabetes.

Stress reduces testosterone, HGH, and dehydroepiandrosterone (DHEA). Combine this with the fact that we're highly catabolic via excess cortisol and reduced anabolic hormones; this will straight up cause the body to not only store fat but also lose muscle! Other consequences are the slowing of metabolic rate, and artificially increasing appetite! Furthermore, the blood pressure responses to mental stress may be enhanced, leading to the development of vascular complications.

Once we were able to diagnose the problem like stress, then we took steps to fix this issue. This individual packed on nice muscle

and the fat started to come off like never before. Meditation played a huge role in lowering his overall mental fatigue.

You can be doing everything right, but sometimes it's the forces we can't see that trip us up the most.

Similarly, I was revising a routine, and upon going over it, I marked zero items red (no fixes/advice given). I was shocked; she was doing everything by the books! Her previous month had been perfect, the daily habits, amazing. I'd never seen a routine so well done, even down to the smallest details. This was a free routine revision, but I felt the need to help as she expressed her frustration that the weight loss was not consistent. I usually don't offer free mental coaching, but seeing as though I could not offer any advice on her eating habits, I extended this option to her. Within ten minutes of talking to her, I realized the issues: Sleep and stress. These are the behind the scenes elements that I can't see in a typical routine revision.

We helped the stress with a method I created called: High-Intensity-Interval-Mediation or "HIIM." This practice of meditation involves powerful breathing techniques to be utilized every day. We also did a series of passive meditation, which involves awareness of thoughts throughout the day.

The sleep was directly affected by the stress. I was proud to say she has started losing weight, just from adding forms of mediation to her routine. I just wanted to share this, for anyone struggling

to lose weight. One of the primary sources of her stress was being overweight, compounded with more stress from not being able to lose the weight. Those emotions all magnified by work stress, and life stress resulted in poor sleeping patterns.

If you feel that you're doing everything right, keep that as the bar, and keep researching and digging. If you're frustrated by the weight not coming off, this very frustration can be the reason for weight gain. Stress not only turns the body into a fat storing machine, but it also saps us of our energy and also overstresses the central nervous system. Over stressed central nervous system brings our whole health down and reduces our ability to metabolize fat.

Stress + Over Stressed CNS + Poor Sleep = Terrible inputs if the desired output is a lean physique.

The mental control that meditation teaches also helps because much of the stress and negativity that resides in our physical body is emotional. Having negative thoughts about ourselves will reflect what we see in the mirror. **You can look better just by feeling good on the inside**, and when people look into your eyes, they see the glimmering joy of being stress-free!

Part Six-The Benefits from Xformation

The Life-Changing Benefits of Xformation

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The following are the benefits of XFORMATION:

- Improved memory
- Improved ability for the body to self-heal
- Improved well-being
- Improved digestion
- Metabolism,
- Stress resistance,
- Cognitive functions,
- Regeneration of skin, nails, hair, muscles,
- Body temperature regulation,
- The growth of new neurons,
- The connections between neurons,
- The production of protein in the brain,
- The number of neuro-circuits activated,
- The number of mitochondria in neurons
- The ability of cells to hold less fatty tissue,
- The number of mitochondria in nerve cells, and
- The production of energy sources for neurons,

- Learning capabilities and
- Overall cognitive functions,
- The ability of neurons to form and maintain connections... GASP...and this program also
- Flushes out the bodies toxins which aid in tissue repair.
- The plan also
- Improves the capacity and speed at which the body heals by reducing inflammation while
- Increasing neurotropic factors which support the growth, survival, and differentiation of developing and mature neurons.
- The plan improves
- The strength of pathways between two nerve cells which the impulses travel via diffusion of a neurotransmitter,
- It increases the production of new nerve cells from stem cells in the hippocampus which is the center of emotion, memory, and the autonomic nervous system
- The program also reduces stress,
- Preventing stress,
- You avoid acne, hives, psoriasis, and rosacea.

Break + Fast = Breakfast

You cannot ever skip breakfast... EVER! If you skipped breakfast, it would have fatal consequences. You cannot skip

breakfast, and if you do, you will starve yourself to death! You are only delaying the inevitable. Eventually, you are going to breakfast, aka EATING! Breakfast just means "breaking-fast." Break + Fast = Breakfast. Delaying breakfast is also known as fasting. Fasting is a challenge for our brain. The brain grows from this challenge by adopting stronger stress response pathways, which train our brain to handle excessive stress better.

Which brings me to my next point... hermit crabs! When a hermit crab gets its first shell, it will eventually outgrow that shell. It has no choice, the pressure and stress make its move to a bigger, stronger shell. Similarly, in life, when we feel pressure and stress, it just means we are in need of an upgrade. Learning to master the power of stress, understanding when to rest and when to go full throttle, is how we grow into our most optimal selves, both mentally and physically.

A picture forms a thousand words. Well, my plan incorporates a unique form of fasting that develops a thousand benefits!

A WORLD FREE OF EXTREME DIET-RELATED DISEASE

Imagine a world where obesity is a thing of the past, and all these illnesses and diseases can be cured. Healing the world of this aliments would save two-thirds of the population each year!

Did you know that heart disease is currently the world's number one killer?

Intermittent fasting has been shown to improve the risk factors related to heart disease!

This Includes:

- High blood pressure
- LDL cholesterol
- Blood triglycerides
- Inflammatory markers
- Blood glucose levels
- Biomarkers of oxidative stress
- Total inflammation
- Hyperinsulinemia

All of these are considered conventional standards of cardiac health risk.

Alzheimer's disease is the world's most common neurodegenerative disease. This condition would be the last thing you want to happen to you. While there is currently no known cure for Alzheimer's patients, we can take measures to prevent it.

A case study in rats shows that intermittent fasting delays the onset of Alzheimer's disease and can even reduce its severity. In a series of case reports, a routine revision that Incorporated intermittent fasting was able to significantly improve Alzheimer's

symptoms in nine out of ten patients!

Other animal studies also show that intermittent fasting helps protect against other neurodegenerative diseases, including Huntington's and Parkinson's disease.

While fasted, the body induces a significant cellular restoration process that eliminates waste material from the body's cells.

More and more evidence is popping up; according to a 2014 review of the scientific writing, intermittent fasting resulted in weight loss of four to ten percent in as little as one or two months, depending on the individual. These same participants also decreased their waist circumference by four to eight percent! It was revealed visceral belly fat was lost, the evil fat we talked about earlier that is found in the abdominal cavity identified to cause disease.

Another case study also showed that intermittent fasting resulted in less muscle loss while on a continuous calorie restriction. **Fasting protects lean mass!**

Type two diabetes has become so common in recent decades that it is not far-fetched to refer to it as an epidemic. This debilitating metabolic disorder results from the mixture of high blood sugar levels in the connection of insulin resistance. Improving insulin sensitivity results in the lowering and regulating of blood glucose levels. In human studies on intermittent fasting, fasted blood sugar was reduced by four to eight percent. Also, fasted insulin was reduced

by as high as thirty percent!

Another study conducted on diabetic rats revealed that intermittent fasting provided protective properties against kidney damage, one of the most severe complications of diabetes. Intermittent fasting with proper meal timing has been known not only to improve insulin sensitivity, but in many cases to **reverse** or at the very least, blunt the progress of Type two diabetes!

Oxidative stress and inflammation are two of the main factors to the acceleration of aging and several chronic metabolic diseases. These chronic diseases develop due to unstable molecules called free radicals, which cause adverse reactions with other important molecules (like protein and DNA) and cause damage to the vital molecules. Several studies show that intermittent fasting enhances the body's resistance to oxidative stress. Numerous studies show that intermittent fasting helps fight inflammation and other key drivers of common diseases.

When we fast, the cells in our body launch a cellular waste removal process called **autophagy**. Autophagy is a regular physiological process in the body that deals with the elimination of cells in the body. It controls homeostasis or standard functioning by protein degradation and turnover of the damaged cell organelles for new cell formation; intermittent fasting promotes and expedites this process.

The autophagy pathway includes the cells breaking down and

metabolizing broken and dysfunctional proteins that build up within cells over time. Increased autophagy may provide protection against several diseases, including cancer and Alzheimer's disease. I'm sure you have heard of the terms detox, body cleanse, and how juicing is the ultimate fix. The truth is, autophagy, as it concerns to intermittent fasting, is the only real cleansing and detoxification process; think of it as a detox on the cellular level.

Cancers are usually described by an uncontrolled growth of abnormal cells. Many cancer cells are glucose-dependent. Fasting has been proven to have numerous helpful effects on metabolism that can lead to a decreased risk of cancer. **Fasting starves out glucose-dependent cancer cells.**

What is beneficial for the body is also good for the brain. We have already discussed the benefits that intermittent fasting can have in regards to improvements in insulin sensitivity in the body; it also decreases insulin resistance for the brain! Fasting reducing oxidative stress, decreases inflammation and lowers blood glucose levels, which in turn promotes cognition function and greatly improving overall mental health.

Multiple studies in rats have shown that intermittent fasting increases the growth of new nerve cells, which have significant benefits for total brain function. Fasting also raises the levels of an important brain hormone called brain-derived neurotrophic factor (BDNF), a deficiency which has been linked with depression

and numerous other brain ailments. Animal studies have also shown that intermittent fasting protects against brain damage as the result of strokes.

One of the most exciting advantages of intermittent fasting is its capability to lengthen lifespan by delaying the aging process. Studies in rats have shown that intermittent fasting prolongs lifespan in a comparable way to that of continuous calorie restriction. In one animal study, **rats that fasted every other day lived over eighty percent longer than mice who did not fast.** This amazing revelation is just the tip of the iceberg as we start to master meal timing and learn more about our bodies.

BODY OF CLAY

To master our bodies, think of the body like a piece of clay; clay that has been lying dormant and cold. People put in a few weeks, don't see the results, and quit. Everyone's clay is molded differently, and some people will need more work. You can mold your clay into whatever desired body by using four simply tools.

The Four Simple Tools:

1. Knowledge
2. Exercise
3. Strategic fasting
4. Motivation

The first tool is knowledge. You must understand your body to manipulate it. Don't let anyone tell you differently; getting lean is pure body manipulation! Your body does not want to be lean and buff. Your body would much rather be at twenty percent body fat than twelve percent body fat. You must impose will to mold your body into greatness!

The second tool to get the clay "warmed up" is exercise. The only way to rebuild a structure is to break it down and build it back up. Working out is the key to getting that lean mass into the mold you desire!

The third tool would be strategic fasting. Strategic fasting is an eating pattern where you cycle between periods of eating and fasting. Split the day or week into eating sessions and fasting periods.

The fourth tool is motivation. There'll be days when you do not feel like rolling out of bed. There'll be days you do not want to work out. Do it anyway! **Do today what benefits tomorrow.**

Knowledge: You can learn everything about the gym, including how to grow muscle and burn fat, or how to get more aerobic and anaerobic strength. Learn the right nutrition and supplements to grow and get that hundred percent bang for the buck out of the gym. Learn how to elongate your muscles and the rest of the body. All of that is great. It is going to school to be a lawyer, going through all the tests and studying, but failing the bar . . . Therefore, you cannot practice

what you've learned. It is all for nothing. You can learn everything, but if you do not go to the gym and apply it, you will not see any results.

Exercise: For some reason, people who are twenty, thirty, and forty years old think that even though they know their bodies have molded into that form for that many years, they can go to the gym for a month and transform all that. They believe that one month of work will transform thirty years of bad habits. If it were that easy, we would all be shredded. The clay (body) has been sitting on the shelf, cold and hard for years. When they go to mold the clay, they get it wet, but it is still hard. It is not going to want to be molded easily. You must apply consistent effort, and then **BOOM!!!** The clay starts to become warm and starts to move and take shape. That is your body going to the gym week after week.

Strategic Fasting: People hear of fasting and think of it as some new fad. Fasting has been around since the dawn of man! It is not a fad, and it is not going anywhere. If you want to try fasting, you must be prepared to do it right! I could not fast if I did not do everything right; it would be too hard.

I had a new client who really wanted to try intermittent fasting. The person came messaged me and was so excited and happy about trying it. But, after the first week the person was already saying: "Man, fasting is too hard!"

-"Did you take your omega 3's?" - I asked.

"Well, I did Monday and Tuesday." The client said sheepishly.

-"Did you drink 3-5 liters of water a day?" - I replied.

He honestly told me: "Well, I did half the week."

With passion, I said: "How do you expect to get to your destination when you are taking detours that are slowing your progress and eating up your gas?!"

He took this analogy to heart. He did what he what supposed to do, and now he has reached his destination.

Motivation: If you're doing this for the girls on the beach, you'll probably fail. Look at yourself in the mirror. Better yet, **look at yourself in the mirror naked.** Do you like what you see?

Ask yourself: "When noon comes around, am I filled with energy or dragging through the day?"

For every pound of fat, there are seven miles of blood vessels! Seven more miles your heart now is forced to pump blood through. Think of the extra strain that puts on the body.

Ask yourself: "Do I want to be able to play with my grandkids when I am sixty?"

Answering the tough questions with the hard truth is what keeps me motivated.

Before your start, learn your why, so you never have to stay up at night asking why.

You Are Going to Die

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Did you know a plant can grow from a crack in the cement? That same plant, if grown in a lovely garden, would grow much stronger. A lot of people live a reactive life instead of a life of action. They do not learn about their bodies because they simply don't need too. Like the plant in the cement, the body will grow and grow nurtured, or not. People grow to a certain age, then glide to the end without ever needing to know how one single hormone works. The difference between plants and us are, we can choose where we grow, how we grow and better yet, why we grow. A plant cannot control the PH of its water, the nitrogen, phosphate, or potassium levels in its food, nor can a plant control the quality of the food it is given. However, we can, yet most individuals just allow life to happen to them instead of taking life by the horns.

The big reason people are unmotivated is the way they perceive life. Average individuals don't see each situation as opportunity to grow. In fact, the average person tends to look at growth opportunities such as school or work, as something they're "forced" to do . . . Instead of something they "get" to do. When you feel lucky to be able to do something, to have a chance, the gratitude will boost your energy levels.

People want to be told they are doing a great job and that everything is OK. **This is YOUR life, YOUR opportunity, No one is going**

to lose the weight for you!

Life is on the wire, and it is solely up to you to make it happen. If you are not where you need to be, it is hundred percent on you, NO ONE ELSE! We win despite our setbacks. We become our best selves through the down times. We dig deep to find our roots.

The hardest part for most people is accepting the fact that you just have to do it. You can get all the motivation, have all the reasons why, trick yourself into really going after it, putting the sticky notes motivational quotes on your bathroom mirror, whatever you have to do, it still comes down to the fact that you have to make a move. Making a move means having the ability to remove yourself from your current mind state, and enter into the body, and take action.

Stop thinking about the pain of right now, the cravings of right now, the energy levels of right now. The good thing about doing everything today to make your tomorrow a better one, is you wake up each day a little stronger, a little leaner, a bit healthier. This compounds over time significantly, until one day you wake up, and you've come so far it shocks you when you look in the mirror.

You & ALL of Your Dreams are Going to DIE

Impending death means you need to take action, **right now**. There may not be another if you don't bring your dreams to life right now. Do not change tomorrow... Not a month from now... Not when you have the motivation to or when you get a break. No, **right now!** If you do

not understand this, nothing else I say will make you understand. **There will NEVER be a perfect time to achieve your goals... EVER.**

Look up when You See the Sun

You don't need perfect timing. You're in the perfect spot right now. I envy you! Yep, that is correct... **I ENVY YOU!** You're yet to take the leap! A WHOLE WONDROUS WORLD of opportunity awaits you! Every win you feel from now on feels like that first kiss, feels like that first victory, feels new and fresh. Yin & Yang my friend.

If you were always happy, you'd not appreciate it. Success is teaching us how to learn from failure. Failure teaches us how to appreciate success. These two elements are interwoven into one another, and would be an incomplete puzzle if one piece was missing. It's essential to realize the importance of practicing gratitude. The root of appreciation stems from pain, displeasure or unease; it grows from adverse situations.

People are not thankful for anything until tested. You don't even notice good health until you've been sick. You don't even think of your liver until it stops working for you. You will never be grateful for feeling good until you have felt doomed. You will never love winning more than you hate losing. The more failures you have, the more you can learn from and appreciate the successes. Without failure, one would not even know success existed.

I watch inspirational videos daily for motivation. However, I listen to what the videos say and then add it to my philosophy. That

way if I ever get lost, I can create my own path. Regret really does suck. If you are almost thirty, and you hold regrets on what you missed out on already . . . imagine that shit when you're eighty!

Jump and learn to grown wings on your way down. The pain of not growing wings in time and going SPLAT on the ground is a slap on the wrist to a life where you get too old to jump . . . And you are forced to watch other people take the same jump you could have made. Imagine being stuck, forever looking at what could have been if you would have just gone for your dreams.

I took the jump and so far, I've hit every other rock all the way down. Hell yeah there are some things I would have done differently! However, at the end of the day, if I'm lucky enough to make it to eighty-years-old, I'm going to be flying. If I'm not soaring, then that means I jumped and went SPLAT.

I don't worry about opportunities I miss; I only focus on the ones still ahead of me. Imagine if plants thought being buried was too hard and quit before ever breaking through. Remember that the Chinese bamboo tree takes five years to break through the dirt, just to grow ninety feet in a few weeks. Keep your head down and look up when you feel the sun!

It was a Dark Knight

I have lost the amount of weight that is equivalent to a small human. I can give you the best guide, the best workout routine. Great.

It will not matter unless you are motivated and want to lose the weight. I can tell you from my experience, if you want to lose the weight, you have to stay constantly motivated. Think of motivation as fuel for your spiritual engine. It does not matter who you are, even "Tony Robbins" probably has down days! There are going to be days when life punches you in the face and kicks you after you fall. So, I constantly keep myself motivated, all the time. Every day, I'm finding new outlets to motivate and increase my energy. The one I always like to think of comes from, well, Batman, The Dark Knight.

Batman throws his strongest punch. Bane: "Ha ha ha!" *Grabs Batman*

Bane: "Your victory has defeated you." *Proceeds to beat the hell out of Batman.*

Batman Takes his batgun out and starts to shoot out all of the lights -With all of Batman's technology, he thinks he will have an advantage in the dark.

Bane: "Ha ha ha... Batman... The dark? THE DARK?"

You have to look at life when the suns not shining and say: "Is this all you got... the dark? This is it? This is all you've got?"

Bane: "Batman! You train in the dark; you adopted the dark... I WAS BORN IN THE DARK! RAISED IN THE DARK! Shaped by the dark! Molded by the dark! I WILL BREAK YOU!"

Recycle your anguish; grow to throw the intense suffering of adversity. I think back to all the times I did not ask a girl out

because I was self-conscious. All the pool parties I dreaded going to. The way I felt eating cake at a birthday party and thought everyone was looking at me. It got to the point where I just had enough. I was sick and tired of the embarrassment I felt. The jokes I would play off. The jokes that were at my expense.

Now, when I'm in the gym, and the pain creeps in, I look at the weights...

Dan: "Is that all you got? Some pain? REALLY? A LITTLE BIT OF PAIN?"

Dan: "Ha ha ha... You think pain can stop me? I was raised by the pain! Molded by the pain! Shaped by the pain! I WILL BREAK YOU!"

I push my hardest, tears and laughter flowing out. I was 100 pounds overweight. The pain is what pushed me. My father's words from ten years ago pushed me. I recycled my pain, and now... I make the pool parties. I'm first in line for cake. I grew the balls to speak to women, and I got one! For the days I wake up, and I am sore, or unmotivated...

"Ha ha ha!"

Moments of Pleasure, Years of Pain

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How do you resist giving up when facing the temporary pain of commitment? I always think three moves ahead, using "the now" as a reference point and trying to pinpoint what decisions (in "the now") can lead to troubling times. If the goal is to lose weight, for example, and in the now you want cake and donuts on a cut day, succumbing to this current craving would only be hurting your future self. Think about it: If you could fast-forward and live in your future self - where you're twenty pounds heavier - you'd slap that cake out of your own hand! It is funny how "the now" just passes over us; this moment and these feelings will soon be gone, and even as you're reading this time is fading away into the next moment. But moments of pleasure can add up to years of pain. Making choices based on your current emotions or cravings is living in knee-jerk reactions. What you do today is an investment in your future, and the things you do at this very moment deserve conscious consideration because they either add value or subtract value from your future life. Always looking three steps ahead is not the easiest thing to do, but thinking of what your future self would want, not your current self, is worth the effort. Stress, worthlessness, sadness, and other negativities are just storms. Put up an umbrella, get to your house, and wait it out. When you stick to your principles, you'll find your struggles soon dissolve into perspective.

Two laws run our lives: The Law of Increasing Returns and the Law of Diminishing Returns. You're either gaining or you're losing. Let's put that into today's perspective. Our current awareness is constant, yet these two laws are always running in the background. Eating cake, drinking alcohol, and not working out might be easy and fun right now, but as the law slowly takes effect, your current awareness will experience great displeasure, when being obese becomes your new current state. But if you think three moves ahead - feel the pain of future failure, future health problems, a future life you don't want to fathom - you find motivation.

Focusing on three moves ahead means focusing less on the current state of things. For example, I used to use a scale often, and the only time it bothered me was when I hit 250 pounds. And then I hit 255 and it bothered me more. When I hit 285 pounds, I threw the scale out of my window, as you know! I was sick and tired of battling it. I continued to gain weight at a steady pace until an abrupt change in my life sparked the beginning of a major turning point in my weight. When I started losing the weight, I did not even think to weigh myself. I just didn't care to bother anymore with it. I realized my emotions would sway. I learned not to worry about what my weight and progress currently were. "When in the middle of play we do not become obsessive over the score." I needed every ounce of mental energy to lose the weight and improve my life. I almost quit trying because I was too concerned with the score.

DITCH THE SCALE

Not losing the weight started to get to me. I was looking at the scale so much it became my primary focus. That is like a basketball player getting whacked in the head in the middle of the game because they are staring at the scoreboard. I learned not to base my life on a number that shows up on your scale; it is just a number. Now I only weigh myself only once a month as a base point and I use the scale at my gym. To this day I do not own a scale, and never will. It only serves as a distraction. I keep my progress by how my clothes fit, how I feel, and by taking pictures of myself and looking in the mirror. By doing this, I lost 100 pounds and have kept it off. Constantly checking the scale is not going to change anything.

I cannot recommend this enough: Ditch the scale. Think of it like a basketball game. If you're consistently focused on the score, your mood will swing. Your motivation will hit highs and lows. When you're doing well, you may feel you have some room to slack, and you will not push as hard. If you see you're not winning, you might get discouraged and quit. What this does is take your mind from the present moment. It expends energy, good or bad. Just implement a good regiment and pay close attention to your body. Take weekly pictures. If you start to feel a bit pudgy, cut back on 200 calories. This is a process and you cannot rush the process. When you're building a house, the foundation comes first. When we build anything that will last, we dig a hole, then we pour the cement and place the post. There

is no difference with weight loss. After gaining weight, we need to stabilize our hormones and jump-start our metabolisms for the months to come.

Most people I have talked to think one cheat day a week is all they need. Stop fearing the weight gain. I've probably gained six pounds this week, which is perfect. The weight will disappear by February, and on a firm foundation, the house will be built. I've been known to take a month off, and while I do not suggest that for everyone, at least a week or two is crucial for your body's health. Throw the scale out of the window and don't worry about what your weight and progress currently are. When in the midst of battle, we do not count fallen foes and in the middle of play we do not become obsessive over the score. You will need every ounce of mental energy to focus on your life, your work, and your relationships. I've known people who have quit trying because they have been too concerned with the score. Not making money, not having a close family, not losing the weight, not having respect... These people looked at the score so much it became their primary focus. Keep your mind only on what's important. Don't base your life on a number that shows up on your scale; it is just a number.

Being self-conscious will strangle your life. Try this: Take a deep breath and hold it. You see, the moment you cling to your breath is the moment you lose it. The only way to get your breath back is to let it go. By clinging to anything you're likely to lose it. Don't

cling to yourself or you'll strangle. If you're just starting out - whether you're a beginner, skinny, or overweight - just get out there and start working out! Focus on your workout and your routine. When you say you're going to do something, DO IT! Don't find ways to back out. Just do it!

In 1519, Captain Hernán Cortés landed in Veracruz to begin his great conquest. Upon arriving, he gave the order to his men to burn the ships. He said, "If we are going home, it will be with THEIR SHIPS!" Retreat was no longer an option for his men. This gave them that extra courage to fight their hardest, knowing it was the only chance they had to survive and to win. Ask yourself: What boats in my life do I keep retreating to? What boats are holding me back from going ALL IN with my life?

KEEPING THE FIRE ALIVE

If you were to ask me how to gain motivation, I might respond by asking if you've ever been lost. And I mean <u>really</u> lost. Once I was traveling from Texas to Arkansas with a friend to attend another friend Steven's wedding. It was getting late as we got close to our destination and I noticed we needed to get gas. My friend told me not to worry because there was a gas station near Steven's place. Our reassurance soon turned to panic when we realized we were out in the boondocks without any cell phone service. There were no street lights and it was dark and cold. We drove around until the tank was empty, and then we walked and walked until we found a corner store.

We used their landline to contact our friend who promptly came to our rescue. Despite the obstacles, we did not quit or settle with being lost. Even when we ran out of gas, even when we were cold and unsure of where we were going, we did not quit.

When you have a destination, quitting is not an option. Being lost is uncomfortable, but you don't just throw your hands in the air and quit. You keep searching and you keep going until you get where you need to go. Even if you're not sure which direction to go, you keep traveling. If you need help, you ask strangers. You get out of your comfort zone and you do whatever is in your power to get to your destination.

My experience getting lost in Arkansas taught me a lot about the human mind. My life changed when I changed my mind and my body. I began to question why the "no retreat, no surrender" mindset only kicks in when we're lost. Why couldn't it be used in our everyday lives? Why couldn't going to the gym or looking after our health be viewed the same way? If we don't settle for being lost, why settle for being overweight?

Why can we look at the weight like we're lost, but no matter what, we keep going, we keep pushing until we are there? It is because we live in our feelings! I know about this. I wake up almost every day with doom and gloom. For the people I motivate and cheer up, I am the clown sitting in the corner all alone when the lights go out. I live this way because my pain is so great, my spirit, so battle

tested, this is my life, I feel like I'm constantly lost, and pushing on, despite my feelings, and despite my outlook for that day. I can relate this to working out. Some days I just don't want to work out, I am tired, sore, unmotivated. I still get in there, refusing just to be "lost." The pain... HAHA, are you kidding me? I put myself in the frying pan baby! Constant burn, never letting up, sweat in my eyes and blood in my mouth. I push through this pain, not living in my feelings, but my principles. At the end of our feelings is nothing. At the end of our principles is a promise. Despite waking up every day, depressed, lost, frazzled... Despite all these feelings I have, the one core pillar for me, my principles, promised me a healthy strong body if I took care of it. My principles promised me a strong mind if I expanded it. My principles promised me my destination if I only kept traveling in its direction.

Create core principles, and stick to them no matter what. There has to be something in your life where you draw the line, and you don't budge, no matter what. This will keep you on track when your emotions try to take over. You may feel sad, or down, but you do it anyway. This builds your habits and eventually becomes second nature. Do what you're supposed to do whether you feel like it or not.

Keep in mind, I was overweight for years! It took until I was twenty-seven years old to make the change that finally worked. I've lost weight before, made progress but I gained it back. Never more than 20lbs or so before it stopped working. The truth is I was

misinformed.

STICK IT OUT

This misinformation made my goals elusive, when you're expecting great things, there is a cost. It requires something of us to stand in a position of readiness, expecting great things only to fail again, and again. When you keep wanting something that you do not get, it can start to wear you down. To work for something and it does not happen cost us more than somebody who wants nothing at all. That is why we have so many people who fall into the pattern of wanting absolutely nothing. Because sometimes it is easier not to want anything, than to want something and not get it.

Bear in mind; success is never an accident. If you do not want it, then move aside because a lot of other people do. I would rather aim for the stars and miss than not to aim at all. I rather try and fail than never to try at all. You can’t walk to your dreams. You can’t skip to your dreams; You have to run after your dreams! You have to be hungry for your dreams! You have to lose all fear of the opposition for your dreams! Go for it, come hell or high water. Don't ask for anything, don't look for anything. Just start, now. Do it. Go. Stop game-planning. Every time you feel like you do not want to do what you know you should do just do it!

Part Seven-The Six Guides

Starters Plan

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Breakdown of Strategic Days

PWO = Post Workout

If you are under 160 pounds, cut 50 grams or 500 calories from the ball park figures below.

If you are above 300 pounds, add 50 grams or 500 calories to the ball park figures below.

Everyone else can use the figures below as a basic guideline.

Refeed Day

Rundown:

- High Calories (around 3,000)
- High Carbohydrate (around 300 grams)
- High Protein (around 150 grams)
- High Fats (around 55 grams)

Eat big. Eat high protein, high carb, and high fats. You can eat burgers, pizza and ice cream! Refeed are typically done on leg day; everything is the same about refeed day compared to a typical workout day except instead of one big post workout meal, we have three

similar meals throughout the day after the workout. Refeed are only used a few times a month on most of my plans and done after a very intense workout.

North Star

- .8-.1 grams of protein per pound of lean body mass.
- Get 2-3 grams of carbs per pound of lean body mass.
- Get .25-.5 grams of fat per pound of lean body mass.
- Omega 3's & multivitamin at night.

Cheat day

Rundown:

- High Calories (around 3,000)
- High Carbohydrate (around 300 grams)
- Moderate Protein (100 grams max)
- Moderate Fats (35 grams max)

What's a cheat day for?

Cheat days are your typical diet break day and done on a workout day or rest day. These are far more common than refeed days and are mostly for people who are unable to train very hard, think of them as a lighter refeed day. Cheat days help level out the body’s hormones. The body is made to go long spurts without food, that's true. However, just because a truck is meant for off-road, if it

travels off-road too much, there will be some damage. How do we repair this damage? Well with trucks, you take them to the shop, with your body - you take it to the kitchen! We fix our hormones by eating a lot of calories. This helps the body overachieve when it comes to performance, instead of underachieving via eating itself to survive. The body can do without a lot of things: Let's see, energy, why is that turned up all the way? Sex drive? Are you crazy? We can't even feed ourselves, let alone babies (Lowers testosterone)! Imagination? Ha-ha yeah, that's a waste of resources. As you can see, if it does not have to do with food, your body starts to throw it off the ship to stop the sinking. So yes, it's not just OK to have a cheat day, it's necessary for long-term weight loss and prevents damage to your body and hormones. It's not what you do once a week that matters, it's what you do the other six days that counts.

Shock Day

Rundown:

- High Calories (around 3,000)
- High Carbohydrate (around 400 grams)
- Lower Protein (75 grams max)
- Lower Fats (20 grams max)

We eat fast acting carbs right when we wake. Fruit, specifically apples, is the superior choice. Shock days are fast breaker days, meaning we do not fast on this day. The first thing is to answer why

we have breakfast in the morning, then I'll give you some examples of what to eat in the morning. So why do we choose to break our fast in the morning at least once a week? The primary benefits of fasting come from hormone control. We know when we fast, that human growth hormone is raised by up to 1,000% and that we become more insulin sensitive; both excellent things for our health. Like with anything, the law of diminishing returns comes into effect. To make human growth hormone, the body needs amino acids. When you eat protein, you're getting up to double the number of grams specified, and most of the amino acids are stored for later use. The body uses these additional amino acids to create HGH. When you fast every day, the body begins to hoard these amino acids in fear of running out. Thus, it starts to produce less HGH. To combat this, we have fast acting carbs in the morning once a week at least to give the body a break from creating ultra-high HGH levels and helps replenish the amino acid reserve. The best source would be from fruit, more specifically - apples. Apples are high in pectin, which binds with water and literally reduces the amount of fat our cells can absorb! Also, apples are rich in fiber, which makes us feel fuller.

Section One (Novice Level)

FORMULA:

This is the formula for people who have been on a calorie restricted diet for over a month. If you have been eating over 3,000 calories daily, then you can move on section one.

PRE-PREP

The Formula:

Week 1: Two Shock Days & eat at Caloric Maintenance the other days with moderate carbs.

Week 2: Day 1: Workout Day – .6–1g per lb of carbs – Caloric Maintenance

Day 2: Workout Day – .6–1g per lb of carbs – Caloric Deficit

Day 3: Rest Day – 50g's of carbs max – Reverse Shock Day (1k below caloric maintenance.)

Day 4: Workout Day – .6–1g per lb of carbs – Caloric-Maintenance

Day 5: Workout Day – .6–1g per lb of carbs – Caloric-Deficit

Day 6: Rest Day – 100g's of carbs max (no fast acting carbs) – Caloric-Deficit

Day 7: Rest Day – 2–3g of carbs per lb pound. – Shock Day (LOW FAT/LOWER PROTEIN! The goal here is carbs, not calories. We do need to be at a surplus of at least 500 calories. We want to get to 2–3g of carbs per BW lb while keeping calories at 500–1k above maintenance. Dextrose powder is good for this. Look for fast acting carbs with lean sources of protein. Protein at .3-.5g per lb.)

This is a basic formula. Some may need a shocking day every other week for a while, and some may need two or three in a row. It all depends on how your body is conditioned when entering this path.

Remember that you really have to confuse the body on Shock Day, it has to get an extreme amount that it's not used to. It's not a "cheat day" or "refeed day" as you commonly hear, this is a Shock Day.

The difference between a "cheat day" and a “shock day” is that, with a shock day, you eat so many carbs that the body literally goes into shock, frantically burning as many carbs as it can as a survival mechanism. You eat carbs in the morning through the night and very little protein and fat. Eat as many carbs as you can handle. If you've never done a Shock Day, test your body first and see where your limits are.

Everyone's different, so just understand the situation and exploit it as much as you can. What I’m saying is, don’t eat a box of donuts, an entire pizza, and wash it down with a keg of beer on your shock day, and blame me if you gain some weight! Test what YOUR body can handle (also, please don’t drink an entire keg at any point!).

Here is the next step.

Formula:

Go into a caloric deficit for 6 days, 7th day being a re-feed day.

One week out of the month, flip the script and go 6 days surplus and 1-day low calorie.

When you're feeling good, incorporate Shock Days on the seventh day instead of a re-feed day. Avoid low carbs except for one day of the week, on an off day. Shock day is an off day. Re-feed is a workout day.

The next step is learning how to do intermittent fasting. Intermittent fasting is simply a form of meal timing.

An example of intermittent fasting would be to only eat during an 8-hour window. For me, I keep it simple and eat six hours after I wake up; I don't try to fit anything into a window. There are no restrictions on what you eat, just when you eat it. If you want to lose weight, then you'll need to burn more calories than you consume for that day; this is basic weight loss theory. A proper fast for me would consist of no larger than a 10-hour eating window; I usually keep mine around six to eight hours. I usually eat right before going to sleep at night, sleep anywhere from six to eight hours, and break my fast six hours after waking up.

There are a few steps I recommend

After waking up, drink one liter of water and take some source of low omega three fatty acids. Do not take this if you take blood pressure medicine.

Optional: One hour after waking up, have a cup coffee with light cream, butter, or black. “Bullet-proof coffee” seems to be all the rage these days. Don’t do that. Do not drink a 400-calorie high

fat cup of coffee first thing in the morning. It will break your fasting state, even though it is a zero carb beverage. Do not go over sixty to eighty calories, and avoid any fast-acting carbohydrates. The objective is to not spike our insulin; once that happens, the magic of the fast is dead. I take a variety of optional supplements, such as super low-calorie amino acids.

Break your fast with something light and easy to eat. The first meal when breaking the fast will be digested very intensely. This digestion saps a lot of energy, so eating too big a meal will leave you feeling tired. When I break my fast on an off day, if I'm not on a specific strategic low-carb day, I like apples. Don't overeat during your eating window, just drink plenty of water and eat like you normally would. There's no need to count calories, just consciously eat less on deficit days and more on surplus days.

Now, stop what you're doing for a second! I want you to take ten deep breaths. Hold in each breath as you inhale and then exhale for five seconds. Pay attention to this: tomorrow I want you to try and not eat until three hours after you wake up. Nothing! Drink one liter of water right when you wake up, and drink black tea or coffee if you want. This part is optional, but it helps.

Bear in mind that intermittent fasting isn't some magic trick; it's optimal meal timing. If you eat way too much even in your "eating window" you'll still gain weight. As I pointed out, many other variables go into it. But intermittent fasting is the optimal

approach. Make sure not to over fast, and not to do it for weeks without breaking your fast early, or having "breakfast."

Week 1: Upon waking, drink 1 liter of water. Eat 2 fish oil caps, drink unsweetened tea or coffee (bullet proof or add 20 calories of butter.) 2 hours after waking: Drink a low-carb (5g carbs or lower preferably) shake with 15-25 g of protein. Drink 2 cups of water after this. Eat the rest of the day as normal. Eat when you're really hungry and have a multivitamin after your meal.

Week 2: Upon waking, drink 1 liter of water, eat 2 fish oil caps, and drink unsweetened tea or coffee (add 20 calories worth of butter.) 2-3 hours later: Drink 1 liter of water. 4 hours after waking: Drink 15-25 g protein shake. If still hungry, eat a low carb pure protein source. Eat the rest of the day as needed and drink lots of water, still, not restricting the diet, just eat as you normally would.

Week 3: Don't eat until 1 pm. Drink 1.5-2 liters of water before you have your shake. A meal at 2 pm is a shake, and all the liquid you should have until after your workout. After working out you'll have another shake. Fifteen mins later have 100 carbs of your choice, preferably fast acting. One hour later, have a big solid meal. For the rest of the day make sure you get enough protein, so if you're 150 g and only had 80g of protein, have a 25g shake or a chicken breast, or both. The goal here is to meet protein macros for the day. This meal will be undesirable because you won't be that hungry, so a shake works best. One day out of the week is a "cheat day": Eat 300g carbs

15 mins after workout, and add carbs to your solid meal too. Go wild, have a cake, doesn't matter.

Week 4: Fast until 2 pm. Liquid until PWO, 30-50 grams of protein after a workout. 15 mins after 100 carbs. Later, have a solid meal protein based low in carbs. For the rest of the day meet protein macros. 1 day a week is "shock" or "re-feed" day, 300g carbs PWO and more carbs with a solid meal for re-feed.

NOTICE

There are no counting calories. This is because when we fast we make it almost impossible to go over maintenance. By simply eating fewer meals while not restricting yourself you can remain consistent. If you mess up a day, it's OK, and it can actually be good thing to shock the system and switch things up. Just try to be as consistent as possible.

Original Dan Plan

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Section Two (Intermediate Level)

The Original Dan Plan:

Step 1: Drink one liter of water right when you wake up. If you're below 160 lbs, drink less.

Step 2: Take omega 3's like fish oil caps or chia seed (no more than 60 calories).

Step 3: One hour after waking, drink one cup of coffee or tea

(no sugar, very light cream/butter if you want).

Step 4: Two hours after waking drink one more liter of water. If you're below 160 lbs, drink less.

Step 5: Six to seven hours after waking drink 25g protein shake (low carb) and one liter of water.

Step 6: Two hours after the first shake drink another 25g protein shake (low carb).

Step 7: 30 minutes to one hour after my second shake, I workout and drink one liter of water during the workout.

Step 8: Right after my workout, I drink a 50g protein shake and 15 minutes after that I have 100 to 150g of carbs via dextrose powder (I eat Twinkies, cookies, donuts, etc.). To elaborate more so you're not freaking out, after an intense workout, your bodies muscle glycogen is depleted. Carbs are what replenish glycogen, and fast acting carbs are what we need to taxi the protein and the carbs to the muscles as quickly as possible. Fast acting carbs with low fat absorb very quickly and spike insulin considerably.

Step 9: One hour after my workout I'll have my big solid meal (whatever I want as long as it has a good amount of protein).

Step 10: How important is protein to your overall fitness? I've experimented with low protein intake (.4-.6 g per lb of lean body mass) and higher (1-1.5 g per lb of LBM). I like to keep it at the higher end for both cutting and bulking, but for bulking you can get a little less since you're in a caloric surplus. By this time, I've

consumed a hundred grams of protein via shake and forty to sixty grams of protein via solid meal (depending on the meal). I make up the other seventh grams via shake, chicken breast, tuna, and other low-calorie protein sources (not very hungry at this time). The point is, no need to eat unnecessary calories for the food we're not really going to enjoy, so I prefer shakes with a chicken breast before bed. Make sure to consume at least .5-1 grams of protein per body pound.

We're doing intermittent fasting combined with a liquid diet for the first half of the day. We're going low carb before our workout to keep our insulin levels very low. Insulin is anabolic, meaning it helps both fat and muscle grow. After a tough workout, spiking our insulin will make our body anabolic when it needs it to build muscle the most. Basically, no fat will be made during this time, and the insulin will mostly boost muscle growth when timed right. Our body becomes insulin sensitive after keeping our blood sugar low all day, on top of working out which makes us even more insulin sensitive. What we get is a super insulin spike post-workout, which will spur our muscle growth.

When insulin levels are very low, human growth hormone is produced the most. HGH helps burn fat and build muscle. Keeping our insulin low all day and doing strength training provides the maximum amount of HGH when combined with intermittent fasting.

The benefits of intermittent fasting would take a whole article in itself, but here are some key points. Throw the calorie tracking

and all that out the window. Get a protein powder that's twenty-five grams a scoop. Take one scoop before training, then after training take two more and have chicken and rice and some Gatorade. Eat until you're full but don't stuff yourself. If you're hungry at night have a shake that tastes good to you. On rest days have chicken, eggs, fish, cruciferous vegetables twice with two shakes. You can fast a little longer, just make sure you eat enough carbs, lots of rice with a sweet dessert, and you're good.

When it comes to macros, there are no "good" or "bad" foods. The only difference is the quality of the food. Chicken and rice are better for us than chicken and a donut. But if the macros of the donut and rice are equivalent to one another, then it's fair game and we can stay on track. Example: If one cup of white rice is fifty grams of carbs and one donut is fifty grams of carbs, then the macro-nutrients are the same. Our bodies only respond to protein, fats, carbs, and calories. It doesn't know we replaced our rice for a donut of equal value.

Macro-nutrients are proteins, fats, and carbs. Every food has macro-nutrients, whether it be donuts, chicken, chocolate, potatoes, and so on. Macros are a number system: 1 gram of protein is 4 calories. 1 gram of carbs is 4 calories. 1 gram of fat is 9 calories. You can eat whatever foods you want as long as you hit your macros. While eating like this, I recommend eating mostly whole, nutritious foods (seventy-five percent) to fit your macros and eating the rest

(twenty-five percent) of whatever you like. Hidden carbs, chemicals or the sugars in processed foods could be another possible cause of a weight loss plateau. You should try to avoid processed foods whenever possible. Don't just look at the nutrition label, check the ingredients list as well. You may find hidden sugars, chemicals, and trans fats that could also trip you up. Don't just assume that all nuts are all the same; some food companies roast them in partially hydrogenated oils that are yet another source of dangerous trans fats. Eat fats. Eat vegetables or supplement with vegan caps daily.

The only thing I count is protein macros, and let me tell you why. The reason I count protein macros is that my whey scoop holds 25 grams and I use two scoops, other than that, I don't count. I don't weigh myself either, having the body you want does not come from constricting your calories or always seeking some goal weight. I had a client who lost seven pounds in a month. Modest, nothing to brag about. But he said, "From the pictures I take weekly, I can tell that a month ago my arms and chest were not as big. I have more definition." Fat takes up around three times more space than muscle. One pound of muscle burns an extra 50 calories a day while at rest; gaining 10 pounds of muscle, you're resting metabolic rate (RMR) increases by an extra 500 calories each day. Now, I don't count calories, I just wanted to let you know that first off, muscle weights a lot more than fat and takes up a third of the room that fat does. So, seeing any improvements in size or definition clearly means two

things: First, it lets you know you've built some lean mass, enough to be noticeable. That could easily be a few pounds of muscle gained. Secondly, it tells us a story. If the muscles are more defined, then that means fat was lost, because no matter how much muscle you have if there is a ton of fat over it, it won't look defined. Now looking at the scale just gives you a number. Well, this is fine if you just want to know your current weight, but if you are looking at it from a fat loss perspective, it is a lie. Think about it-- the scale doesn't tell you how much muscle weight you gained, so the actual fat that was lost is greater than the scale says. Visceral fat is the fat that is attacked first when fasting. People can actually lose fat pounds while not seeing a big difference in the mirror because you lose the visceral fat that is nestled next to internal organs, deep inside you first. The fat on the outside is not bad, it is a good source of fuel. It is just the visceral fat that we need to get rid of.

IMPORTANT SIDE NOTES:

Drink at least three to six liters of water a day for six days of the week, drinking less water on one day (this helps the body use the water more efficiently), around two liters. Gauge the amount of water according to your size, see what works best for you. The more water you can handle the better. I personally drink two gallons a day usually. I have found our bodies can handle much more water than we think. I recommend drinking no more than one liter every two hours.

Drink at least two liters of water before your first shake. Take a multivitamin daily. I take creatine daily (optional). I work out four to five times per week, doing abs as a second daily workout at night.

If the goal is to burn fat, then you'll need to be at a caloric deficit (burning 500 calories more than you are taking in). Example: If my total calories burned for the day is 2,500 calories, then I would have to eat two thousand calories to be at a deficit and burn fat or lose weight. Consistency is essential for both building muscle and burning fat. For burning fat, I recommend staying in a deficit for six days straight, then on the seventh day have a refeed day.

In a famine, our metabolism will slow down, so the importance of the refeed or shock is to boost metabolism

Staying in a Famine for too long without proper refeed or shock days will put a halt on the fat burning process.

On Shock days you want to take in hundred percent more carbohydrates

(If your carbs are set at 150 grams per day for six days, you should take in 300 grams of carbs on the seventh day)

Build Up to The Intermediate Level Guide

If you can only wait for two hours to eat after you wake up, then do that. Let your end goal be my plan, but until then build up to it. Baby steps are nothing to be ashamed of, it is still progress.

Expert Plans

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Section Three

Training your body takes a very determined effort. Slacking off or cutting corners is not good enough. You must pay in full and in advance. The first step is intermittent fasting (IF). Fasting will reset your hormones and regulate your metabolism. For people who have a hard time at first with IF, they should take it slowly. Maybe start with a liquid breakfast for a few days, then a liquid breakfast/lunch, and wait to have carbs until after your workout. Don't stay in this phase for long, you need to keep making progress.

Once you are able to postpone your first meal around six to eight hours after waking, you can move on to fasted workouts. Do this slowly, really push yourself, but be smart. Once you can train during a fast, you're on your way to controlling your body, which is the first step in controlling your mind. You'll have to endure physical pain. Your character will be tested on days you don't feel like doing it. Wake up and drink one liter of water. Take a little caffeine if you need to, go without it if you can.

I wake at 5 am and workout at 4 pm; I don't eat during this period. If I do eat before my workout. It will be one 25g protein whey shake, 30 minutes before I work out. After my exercise, I ingest 50g of whey protein post workout (PWO) with 0.5 per body pound of simple carbs via dextrose. All liquid, no fats, no fiber, nothing to slow down

digestion. My gym is one mile from my house, so I walk there and back, all fasted. I'll wait for at least 15 to 20 minutes PWO to get the most of my HGH secretion, on workout days like leg day in the gym, I'll push this even further. The reason is my body will absorb the nutrients so fast that this little time difference will not matter and the HGH secretion slows down drastically at around 20 minutes PWO. I'll wait around one to two hours to eat my solid meal, which can have some complex carbs such as peanut butter. No simple carbs, nothing that's going to spike my insulin drastically. Remember we want to maximize our first HGH release when we fall asleep.

It takes 4 hours for our spike to subside, so timing the PWO carbs at 4 hours before sleeping gains us what we need. I will eat around 60-75g of protein in this meal. Then for the last meal, I will have 75g of protein (50g casein 25g whey). It's good to have fast acting whey in there to help with the HGH release at night (muscle building).

Every Sunday is my shock Day. I do not fast on this day, I eat carbs after my water. Usually organic cookies.

Every other workout day, I like to spike my insulin all post workout and before sleep. I want the anabolic effects of the insulin to grow, but also find it a nice chance to give my body a break from producing HGH, which will lead to bigger HGH releases later on. We grow and gain future equity.

Section Four

If you want to lose belly fat, you will, but remember you can't target fat loss. There is no way to spot reduce fat. We lose fat by our overall mass.

Humans hold on to fat for strategic reasons.

Fat reserves store in very specific areas on the human body. Generally, the fat stores try and avoid the "flexion folds" at the joints in order not to hinder movement. Fat stores are often the same in both sexes, the one main difference is in the greater storage for women. Most reasons the areas contain more fat in them then others, is usually for protection from either outside trauma or protection of joints.

The lower back and belly are usually the most stubborn areas to lose weight and for me, always are the first to gain fat and slowest to lose it. There is a reason for that.

Lower Back

This fat merges with the upper buttocks so that the buttocks is raised in height. This helps further support of the buttocks.

Thighs

Very common in women, fat in this area has an aesthetic role. It fills the space between the two thighs. Usually more noticeable in women rather than in men.

Pubis

Right above the penis/vagina, this area stores more fat in order to

protect the pubis from blunt force trauma. This is often referred to as "lower belly fat". You may have also heard the term “FUPA” which is an acronym for “fat upper pubic area”.

Knees/Ankles

In women, the knee and ankles are often a location of fat buildup. This is to protect the joints, and is greater in women because they need the extra protection while pregnant.

Breasts

The breast is made of fat surrounding the "mammary glands", being held together by connective tissues resting on top the pectorals. Women have extra fatty tissue built up here for breast feeding and carrying more milk.

Upper Arms

Especially developed in women, this area holds more fat because it protects the nerves and arteries.

It's helpful to know that there is a reason why pesky stomach fat is so hard to get rid of. Just know that battling it out with losing those last pounds is totally normal.

Introducing the hardest plan in this book.

This plan should not be performed for longer than a month before switching back to one of the less extreme plans.

Water fast until 2pm-6pm, switch it up. Break your fast with 10-15g of protein via BCAA powder. Your body will absorb all of the

protein before your PWO shake and will stay in a fasted state. We want our body to be empty to increase the absorption speed of our PWO shake. The body slows down its absorption rate when it's in the process of digesting food. If there is so much protein in the system that there is a backup, the body will absorb the protein at its leisure.

Let's say you ate a steak for lunch. Digesting the steak will tax a lot of energy, and the body won't absorb the PWO protein shake as efficiently. We want the body to think it has no protein when it needs it the most, then wallop it with easy to digest whey protein and fast acting carbs.

Drink one liter of water right when you wake up. Take omega 3's like fish oil caps or chia seed (no more than 40 calories). Two hours after waking, drink 1 more liter of water. Ingest 7–12grams of BCAA powder in a shake one hour before working out. Twenty minutes after your workout, drink your PWO protein shake (.2-.3 grams of protein per lb.) – The HGH release will start to weaken drastically at around 15mins PWO. The benefits of leaving the "dripping hose" on will not outweigh the benefits of going anabolic & getting your body completely nourished. Ingest fast acting simple carbs (.4-.6 grams per lb.) 10mins after you ingested the protein. Use all liquid for max absorption rate... No fat, no fiber, no vitamins or fish oil, only fast acting whey followed by fast acting simple carbs. Always get enough vegetables. I take vegan caps daily. Have a solid meal

2 hours after the workout. Try and make it healthy and high in protein. No restrictions here, just do not go crazy. You can have your hamburger and fries. Get 1-2gs of protein per lb. daily. On refeed day go lower on the protein, get .5-.7g per lb.

There is a 2nd HGH spurt. It occurs about one hour after the first, especially if in fasted state. To pull this off, you will require more protein intake before your workout. I've tested this and found that the first option works best for my lifestyle and I think it is the most optimal choice for recovery.

Section Five

When you get to such a low body fat level, you must be very careful with your cutting strategy. At this level, tricking the body no longer works as well. This is because the body knows that it’s fat stores are low. The lower body fat you achieve, the harder it gets to lose any fat. This is where WILL and DETERMINATION take over. You don't trick the body. You impose your will upon it. You must lift the fat away.

This is NOT a workout guid., This is what you do outside of the gym.

You're following this guide, your base guide as always. But now, we're going to tweak it. The main difference is you're going to have liquid carbs BEFORE, DURING, and AFTER the workouts. You can no longer afford to go low carb before your workouts- preserving muscle mass

is the key here. I have dextrose powder or Gatorade. I like Gatorade.

You must lift the fat away, and fat is lost through caloric deficits.

We have a "maintenance weekend" 3 weeks out of the month with the last week being a maintenance week.

We have one refeed day every 10 days, no shock days. We need the fats and higher protein of the refeed days.

Lifting is essential, we must lift with high intensity.

NO CARDIO! NO HIIT! Our body fat is too low to risk raising our heart rates. You can lose muscle in the blink of an eye when you're at such a low body fat.

Protein intake should be at 1.5 grams per body pound.

Take a slow walk on an empty stomach for 20-30 mins, EVERY morning. Do this early, preferably right after you drink your liter of water when waking up.

Going from 12% to 8% was harder and longer for me than going from 30%+ to 15%, so don't get discouraged. If it were easy, everyone would be ripped.

Optional - One 24 hour fast every 14 days following a re-feed day.

Advice

There will be times where you feel like bulking & cutting. With intermittent fasting, this is a good signal to do what your body is telling you because once you've reached this level, your hormones

will be balanced and your body will no longer "lie" to you.

Let's say you're 15% body fat and want to cut to 10%, and you get to 12% and feel like eating everything in sight, especially carbs. Go with the flow, don't fight against what your body is saying it wants. Then you bulk from 12% back to 15%, then you'll feel like cutting and not crave carbs so much. This is natural, you may do this and get right back to where you were with fat percentage, but with added muscle, added testosterone, added stamina, and strength. Keep going with the flow, and you'll build a very strong solid core. The more muscle you have, the more calories you'll have to expend to maintain just the muscle mass. Then when you cut, you'll lose weight faster, eventually getting you to 10% body fat. A badass 10% with tons of muscles. It sounds funny, but most people are too skinny to maintain 10% body fat! You need to build muscle to help raise our daily caloric maintenance level to help you keep your transformation.

My Thoughts

I starting writing because I like it. I was never that good at it, but I never gave it a chance. I've noticed that since starting my Quora account, I've received a lot of questions, some of which scare me because of how the mindsets are. You're not going to have one supercut that will get you to 10%. If you do, you'll end up gaining it back, which isn't bad, because you will gain muscle mass, but you are torturing yourself mentally if you're not equipped with the

knowledge beforehand. Instead, realize to get to 10% and maintain it you need muscle mass, no matter if you're a man or a woman. So don't force it, go with the flow, hell it might take you 4 months, or a year, but know that when you get there, you'll stay there.

People's big issue is they get from 30% to 15% and think, man I didn't even hit one plateau! I only have 7% more to go! Yaaay! They climbed the mountain non-stop, just to reach the summit. Now it's time to build your own mountain, stone by stone you must stack to get that 6 pack.

Section Six

Hunger levels

The difference between knowing your cravings. A big thing I want to teach you is how to lose weight and set up a system that relates to you. First, is knowing the difference between hungry feelings. Let's say there is a plate of delicious smelling food you like. If you look at the food and have no appetite, no desire to eat any, this is considered a down day. To combat this, we have a shocking day. If you look at the food and it looks tasty, and you could eat some, but choose not to, this is the desired feeling we want. To have "good" hunger, without the cravings. If you cannot look or smell the food without needing a bite, this is a craving. Uncontrollable urges are red flags. This should be a sign to break your fast with fast acting carbs such as fruit and to shorten the length of your fast.

The next thing is to watch out for should be your energy levels. Take note if you have low energy or depression, moderate to healthy energy levels or high energy levels. You do not want to be stuck in a six-hour window or eight-hour window; we are not robots. We must conform to our bodies' needs. If you wake up and that day is a workout day, but you feel tired and hungry, this is not a good day to work out and should be shifted to a shocking day.

Your energy levels should dictate how long you fast. If you have the preferred "could eat but choose not to" feel, and healthy energy levels, then there is no need to break your fast. If you are starting to feel a bit low on energy, then time to break your fast. If you have cravings, it is time to break your fast and increase water uptake, and best to break the fast with fast-acting carbs and have a shorter fast the next couple of days.

Setup for each day, and record the information below:

Energy Levels / Breakfast Times / Hunger Levels

Part Eight - A Doggie Bag to Take with You

Tips & Tricks for Faster Weight Loss

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Supplement Timing Techniques

Once every five to ten days, I don't take any omega 3's, or vitamins, or any and all optional supplements. I also go very low water and protein. The reason is, if the body believes that it's got an endless supply of, for example, Omega 3's, it won't utilize the Omegas as efficiently. Apply this from vitamins to water to even protein. The body will excrete excess unabsorbed vitamins, omegas, etc. The more nutrients we can absorb in any given setting the less we waste. We can take further steps to increase absorption rates and efficiency, like alkalizing our bodies first thing, but just taking a day off from lots of water/protein and any optional supplements. This will help tremendously with how efficient you absorb nutrients, which helps with hunger, among other things. Ebb and flow -- the key to excellent health.

Tips for the Holidays

I've been traveling for the holidays, and like most people, my eating habits have been in hectic {fast acting carbs in the morning and night). This is fine! It's good to take a break from trying to be perfect. Enjoy your holidays and your food. Just know when you

get back to the plan, the fat will pour off.

Out of the Box Weight Loss Tips

Rest days if trying to save muscle. The reason cold showers are very useful while fasted is that when the body's temperature lowers, it burns calories by raising its internal temperature. When fasted, the body only has fat to use as fuel. Cold/Hot showers jump start the body, slightly increasing HGH and metabolism. It also increases the benefits of cortisol, naturally waking us up. This helps me push my coffee back a few hours. It's also a good way to flush lactic acids out of the muscles to help recover faster. Start off cold for 30 seconds then switch to hot. Rinse and repeat.

Tips for Fasted Walking

While eating the body is burning the food, not the fat. Not eating and then walking forces the body to burn fat as fuel. Walking does indeed raise GH levels! It's always best to walk in a fasted state if the goal is to enhance overall GH levels. Eating spikes insulin and insulin makes us anabolic, and this severely stunts growth hormone levels. There is a linear correlation connecting the size of the GH release and intensity of the training. Slow 30-minute walks in a fasted state slightly increase GH levels. Short spurts of fast paced walking and or sprints drastically increase GH levels. Resistance training results in a sizable GH increase; load and frequency are deciding factors in the control and size of the GH

release. Extended endurance exercise (moderate cardio like jogging) results in decreased resting GH; which links to a high tissue responsiveness to GH. Shorter, yet more intense workouts have to be proven to increase GH more than longer, drawn out workouts. Forty minutes total of intense strength training, with proper rest periods, is the ideal length to harness the most out of our hormones.

Training at an intensity higher than the lactate threshold can produce a 200 percent increase in GH for more than twenty-four hours! However, incorporating a brisk morning walk after drinking a tall glass of water is a nice little way to improve human growth hormone naturally. While walking, try active meditation, which also has been proven to help promote a healthy atmosphere in which GH can prosper. Active meditation involves actively breathing, (paying attention to inhaling & exhaling) while doing an activity such as walking. The small things like walking and focused breathing add up to make a big difference for overall well-being & health.

A Little Carb Timing Trick

When going into a workout with insulin lowered, the body is obliged to burn fat for fuel for workouts. Insulin is anabolic, so eating carbs after a workout help muscles grow. The carbs converted to glucose are mainly used to restore deleted glycogen in our muscles and liver, and not converted to fat. After working out, this period is "free game," where one can eat whatever they wanted as along as it is high in protein and carbs.

Have more liquid meals and only eat one or two solid meals a day. The body needs the energy to metabolize fat, the whole "need money to make money" scenario; the body needs the energy to make energy. The more excess energy available for the body to use for metabolizing fat cells, the better. Not to mention protein shakes are lower in calories which lead to more fat being burned. I like to eat one big solid meal a day and keep the rest of my meals liquid.

Rule of Thumb for Calorie Timing

Eating two thousand calories over the span of 10+ hours is not the same as the span of three hours. While getting most of your daily calories around your workout, this will always be a rule of thumb when using my guides.

Tips for Responsible Fasting

Fasting too long – I do this all the time. But I'm also playing the guinea pig. So far the results are excellent, but it's a dicey business, very sensitive, and it's very easy to overdo things.

Think of fasting like working out. The first few hours are nothing, just the warm-up. The more reps (hours) you do, the more stress that is deployed. Then you reach the point of failure. We can go past this point of physical failure because we come with our very own coach our mind. So, just as in lifting you can go past failure with support from a partner, we can do the same when we fast. The difference experienced between the sixteenth and twentieth hour is dramatic; we're talking five times more stress and productivity. If

we suffer muscle failure every time we work out, this will fail us because our central nervous system (CNS) will start to operate at a lower frequency. The CNS relates not just to our muscles – it affects our entire body, and how we operate. When the CNS is too stressed to enable maximum capacity, our body does not do anything well: it sucks at burning fat, and it sucks at building muscles, but it's excellent at catching a cold. I stress this a lot – don't over-fast consistently.

Tips to Avoid Overeating

Little things can help. On top of living a healthy lifestyle – and presuming you're following one of my basic plans, or at least practicing intermittent fasting – these tips can help combat overeating.

After the first meal of the day, plan an activity for directly afterward. Get out of the house or go to a different room from the refrigerator. Buy "cheat day" foods on cheat day, not the day/week/month before! Purchase/prepare your post workout meal either directly before or after the workout. One cookie doesn't have to be the whole box! Realize it's OK to slip up sometimes and don't let this depress you as this will make you more likely to overeat. The next day you can always change your strategy to take advantage of the previous day's lapse.

There is no such thing as a bad day, only a bad way! The "bad" day can be used the following day to shape the new right way. We can

restore our willpower and usually, after a "collapse" we can pick up our level of determination again the following day.

Don't eat standing up. Sit down and enjoy an excellent dish. Don't have your meal in front of the TV. Really make an effort to enjoy every bit. Most people eat out of habit, and eat quickly, watching a show or walking around. It is all too easy to eat a whole meal and fail to appreciate it! Realize that often when you feel like eating it's not hunger, it's a habit!

Mental Hacks

Beware of the wrong mindset. One cookie doesn't need to be the box! Just because you eat one "bad" food item, that doesn't mean it's all over! A client of mine said: "Once I eat one treat or bad snack, I feel like I've lost, and that the whole day's ruined, so I might as well binge. It's like, once I start, I can't stop!" Look at it this way: If you accidently ding your car with a shopping cart in the parking lot, do you think “well, I’ve already scratched the paint, I might as well keep smashing the cart against my car!”? It’s the same thing. It makes the same amount of sense. No sense at all.

When waking up and feeling hungry, remember that it's most likely dehydration that's causing it. Keep in mind that humans can go three weeks without food! If going one day without food was that taxing on our body, we wouldn't stand a chance of continuing for two weeks. On the other hand, if you go just one day without water, you're almost a quarter of the way towards dying! Four days without water

will most likely cause irreversible damage and even death! It's a scary thought... and it puts into perspective the "hungry" feeling we get in the morning.

Metabolism Map Trick

It's damn near guaranteed that every three weeks I have this spurt where my body naturally doesn't want to take in much. I found this through the study of my notes, as I make a note whenever I have irregular cravings or vice versa. Believe it or not, my system works! I now have a rough map of my metabolism. On the weekends I usually have no chance. There's no point fighting it, so I ride with it. It makes sense – I always ate more on weekends throughout childhood as there was no school. Take notes of "odd" days, when you're feeling overly hungry or tired, and days where it's just the opposite; this information will be invaluable later on. Make sure to list what you did that day and the previous day to get a more detailed map.

Deciphering Hunger Levels Tip

When someone feels famished and has pains in their stomach, this may be a sign that they are starving (meaning, days and days with no food). Feeling starved can be an artificial craving, usually caused by some level of dehydration and/or nutrient deficiency. A person's mental condition, such as depression or too much stress, can affect such cravings as well. Such states can create mixed signals similar to those triggered by dehydration, causing the body to crave fast-acting foods. It's not a coincidence that when people are sad,

they love chocolate.

Not feeling hungry at all should be a red flag. A lot of people get happy when they have no appetite. This is a bad sign because this insinuates that the metabolism is slowing down. The metabolism is a pretty practical system, but it may not be running as high as it can. When days of no appetite turn into weeks of no appetite, it's time for a feast day to shock the body's metabolism back into shape.

When you can eat, but do not crave food, this is a healthy sign of a good-running metabolism. You see, fasting should not be the easiest thing in the world – food should look appealing – but you have the willpower not to eat it because you are not having cravings. When someone asks you if you are hungry a good answer would be: "I could eat." You want to be a bit hungry all the time during your fast, but, it should be no issue to go without food.

My hunger levels dictate my days. If today was a "cut" day and I am feeling cravings, I will switch it to a "shock" day at the drop of a hat. Now, don't go having shock days every time you have cravings and/or are not hungry – that is, until you've mastered your body by keeping it properly nourished and hydrated. Then the body will not lie, and we can trust it and adapt accordingly.

Coffee Tips & Tricks

Coffee is cheap, and it provides a boost to energy and cognitive functions. However, there has always been a debate about whether it's good for pre-workouts or for health in general. After doing my

research and testing it for myself, I've come up with some surprising findings for coffee.

Coffee, I discover, can increase metabolism by up to 20%! It also provides us with a temporary metabolic boost. Other functional benefits of a pre-workout cup of coffee include improved workouts and fat loss. Caffeine has been shown to increase muscular endurance and lower pain levels during strength training and HIIT. So, it's a great option for the pre-workout! (It's recommended that 300 milligrams (mg) of caffeine be consumed 30 minutes before physical activity to get the benefit it can provide.)

Caffeine promotes the utilization of fat stores for energy over glucose, which means caffeine has fat-burning properties. Active people get a "glycogen-sparing" effect from caffeine because it promotes the mobilization of fats. Caffeine boosts "beta-oxidation," a by-product of increasing translocation of fatty acids from the cytosol into the mitochondria. It also improves mental alertness by blocking the action of phosphodiesterase.

Increased Microcirculation

According to an article in Health Magazine, Japanese researchers recently discovered that people experienced a 30% increase in capillary blood flow after drinking just five ounces of regular coffee, compared to those drinking decaf. Improved blood circulation typically equates to improved oxygenation of our tissues, which may enhance our fitness performance and how fast the

nutrients get to our muscles PWO.

Muscle Preservation

Coffee triggers something in our brain that releases a growth factor called "Brain-Derived Neurotrophic Factor (BDNF)." Besides the brain, BDNF also expresses itself in our muscles, where it contributes to the neuromotor and the most critical element in our muscles. Neuromotor degradation is part of the process that explains age-related muscle atrophy. This means coffee can help maintain more youthful muscle tissue. This suggests that caffeine may help preserve our muscles as we age while reducing our risk of any injuries.

More Stamina

Stamina and endurance are key to most things in life. Get this: a 2005 meta-analysis concluded that caffeine can reduce our perceived level of work by more than 5%. This makes the perception of our workouts feel easier. It's basically a Jedi mind trick. Caffeine can improve exercise performance by more than 11%! This appears to be related to the reduction in the perceived level of exhaustion. Simply amazing!

Pain Reduction

A caffeine dose equivalent to two or three cups of coffee taken one hour before a half-hour-long workout can lessen the number of perceived muscle pains. This pain reduction could allow us to push ourselves harder, which is important during strength training. Research from the University of Georgia, in "The Journal of Pain,"

reported something similar. They say consuming two cups of coffee an hour before training reduces post-workout muscle soreness by up to 48%! Studies using Aspirin produced a 25% decrease in PWO soreness.

Improved Memory

BDNF boosted by coffee intake also activates brain stem cells to create new neurons in our brain, which can have benefits for our brain function. Research conducted at Johns Hopkins University found 200 mg of caffeine improved volunteers' memory for up to 24 hours.

Choice in Coffee

So, which kind of coffee to choose? Dark roast or light roast? The rule is: the darker the berry, the sweeter the juice; the darker the roast, the better the health benefits. Roasted coffees are higher in neuroprotective agents than unroasted coffees. A new study in Molecular Nutrition & Food Research found that dark roast coffee restored blood levels of vitamin E and glutathione better than lighter coffee. The dark roast also helped with weight loss, with significant body weight reduction in volunteers. The lighter roast didn't provide the same effect. Other studies have shown that dark roast coffee produces more of a chemical called "N-methyl pyridinium," which helps prevent the stomach from producing too much acid. This means the darker roast coffee could actually be easier on the stomach than the lighter roast.

Get the most out of your coffee. When it comes to achieving the most benefits from coffee, we need quality coffee. The difference

between quality coffee and "grade b" quality coffee is like night and day. Go organic. Coffee beans are one of the most heavily sprayed crops when it comes to pesticides, so you should select only coffee beans that are certified organic. Go for whole bean coffee. You'll want to purchase whole bean coffee that smells and tastes fresh – if your coffee doesn't have a fresh smell, it's probably bad. Drink it with light cream, and if you're interested in the health benefits, drink your coffee without sugar. Add sugar, and you'll nullify any of the benefits discussed above by spiking your insulin levels, which leads to insulin resistance. Adding a few healthy fats, from cream or butter, will promote cognitive functions without spiking insulin levels. (No more than 65 calories.) When it comes to coffee mugs, avoid plastic and Styrofoam cups because poisonous chemicals will leech into your drink. I recommend glass and ceramic travel mugs. Bear in mind, also, those coffee filters are filled with toxic chemicals, literally. Make sure you use non-bleach filters.

The Dark Side of Coffee

Please, remember that the caffeine in coffee is a stimulant and highly addictive. I wouldn't rely on coffee as my everyday go-to for energy. Remaining sensitive to coffee is key to receiving any of these benefits. It will only offer diminishing returns if abused. Coffee also dehydrates, so make sure to drink plenty of water before your workouts.

Cardio Tips

A most inefficient form of exercise to burn fat the moment we step off the treadmill we stop burning calories. With strength training, we burn calories for up to 48 hours after. We burn more calories sleeping on an off-day from strength training, than we would doing cardio for 2 hours. We must break down the muscles, so we continue to burn calories after our workouts via rebuilding of muscle tissue. Moderate cardio does not achieve this. Strength training and HIIT (high-intensity interval training) accomplish this. Cardio depletes energy & is detrimental to building muscle When recovering from strength training, power is crucial in the rebuilding process. Doing cardio when we should be resting is a huge detriment to the muscle building process. The more muscle mass we accumulate, the easier it is to burn fat. HIIT & lite-weight-high-rep circuit training, are much more efficient at building muscle endurance.

Of course, it's true. Repairing muscles require energy. Cardio requires energy. If we're doing cardio when we should be resting, it will definitely hurt our gains by depleting our energy reserves, and our muscle’s glycogen. It will also stress our CNS (central nervous system), which will hurt our gains. Cardio saps energy that could be used in our strength training to get more intensity our of our workouts. When doing steady state cardio for fat loss, it is a bad investment because as soon as you step off the treadmill or end your jog, you stop burning calories. A better investment would be working out with weights. Initially, you will burn less than a cardio

session. However, after the workout your body is still burning calories, so in the same amount of time you will burn more calories from weight lifting than from cardio in the following 72 hours. Cardio after being done for an extended period of time, the carbs will be gone in the first 20 minutes, and it will bypass the fat and go straight to the muscles. By lowering your heart rate and having the correct rest periods in-between sets or fasted walking.

Q&A

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Q: "Breakfast is a break from fasting from the 13-15 hours you haven't eaten since dinner. You wake up hungry. The best time of your day for thought or activity is the morning. Your thoughts?"

A: Fasting increases alertness and focus. Eating requires energy and does not deliver the energy until it's digested unless we're talking fast acting carbs, which are more like a drug. I've written about this extensively, and I will take the beatings that come with going against what society thinks. I would be hard pressed to find ANYONE that puts in half the effort I do when it comes to studying and actually putting into practice. Breakfast would put me at my worst again. Saps my energy via digestion, never giving my body time to excrete last day's meals because eating first thing in the morning. People who need carbs for energy in the morning are no different than a drug addict who needs a fix to get through the day. We produce HGH for a reason, for the time we go without food, which is supposed to be often. We're built for that, and if you go against nature, you get 10-year-olds to 200 pounds.

Q: "What's an alternative to the protein shakes?"

A: Liquid protein of any kind. Meaning it could be powder eggs,

or soy based if you're vegetarian. It has to be liquid for my plan to work the best.

Q: "Is there a reason why you are dividing the protein intake before the actual meal unlike the proper IF technique? Why did it work well for you? Doesn't a shake imply carbs and sugar too? (i.e. if you add fruits and veggies to it)."

A: I have done every IF method on the internet. From lean gains to Dr. Mercola. They all work well, but I can guarantee you mine will have the best results. I always recommend protein shakes low in carbs no sugar. I use combat protein which has 5g of carbs and 0 fiber and 0 sugar. Do not mix in fruit or anything, just find a good source of protein with low carbs no sugar. There are several reasons for this. I will name the most important. Eating takes a lot of energy, so does burning fat. Before working out, you want to ingest food that will be easiest to digest, (low carb protein shakes are on top of the list for that). This will make a noticeable difference in your energy levels (they will sky rocket). More energy for your workout and to burn fat AND to build muscle. Really, I could write a book on why this is so important, which I probably will. Eating raises insulin, even protein. The spike from protein is minuscule compared to carbohydrates. Liquid protein will spike your insulin the least, aside from pure BCAA. In the book I am actually writing, ingesting

BCAA is on the "hardcore" plan. This is not for everyone, and not what I did to get this thin. It's just a perk I've discovered and do as I progressive into the ultimate fat burning and muscle building routine. The combination of more energy and lower insulin levels will lead to your body having more energy to burn fat and low insulin, so you will burn fat longer than the other IF routines you've read about. When you ingest just a shake with low carbs, your insulin spike will actually only last 30 minutes to an hour, and bring you right back to a fasted state. The longer the fast + proper nourishment is another boost.

Q: "Do you mix the protein powder with milk or water?"

A: Water. You can mix whatever you want PWO. Do not mix any carbs pre-workout however.

Q: "If trying to lose weight, do you still recommend those "snacky" foods for PWO carbs? I keep seeing so much conflicting information on this. The most recent site I visited said donuts were terrible and that whole wheat toast with peanut butter is better."

A: Yes, you can have "snacky" foods PWO. If you're like me, you have to have your snacks. This is a good way to have your cake and eat it too. I always tell my clients you have to earn the snack. Do

not listen to anyone saying that you can't do this because I lost 100 pounds and I did exactly that. You can tell I was not born with a fast metabolism either.

Q: "Gotcha, thanks! For those of us who aren't crazy about sugary foods, though, are other carb sources like white rice and pasta acceptable for the two loads?"

A: Yes. Any "fast" acting carbs work great. Rice is great.

Q: "On Sunday I did the shocking day (high carbs, low protein). Do I fast as well? Or should I be eating breakfast?"

A: No fasting on shock day. Fast acting carbs first thing when you wake. Lower water this day too, around 2 liters max. Try to avoid caffeine on shock day.

Q: "My big solid meal PWO: how big is too big? Mine have been pretty big (day 1: whole burger + fries, fruit; day2: half a pound of chicken with broccoli sprouts and fruit and a milkshake). How much should I limit myself here?"

A: No, this is good.

Q: "Do you have brand suggestions for vitamins and fish oil?"

A: I get my omega's and vitamins from GNC and just get the GNC brand.

Q: "How long after eating should I go to bed to get the maximum GH spike? (noticed your FB post the other day about not blunting GH with insulin)."

A: Cut carbs out 3-4 hours before sleep, protein is ok.

Q: "How many hours before going to bed should I have dinner? I finish work at around 8, and my goal is to go to sleep at around 10:30-11:00."

A: If it's 8 pm, then don't worry about it, eat until you sleep if you want.

Q: "Would it be okay to have fruit and cereal (all bran/complete/fitness) at dinner? Anything to drink?"

A: On workout days yes, if not a workout day, if you must, have it mid-day.

Q: "Should I have snacks in between lunch (big meal) and dinner, like fruits?"

A: On workout days it's fine, on off days, stick to as many shakes as you can.

Q: "I just wanted to make sure you said that for my big meal after my workout there are no restrictions, is this correct?"

A: Exactly. No restrictions on the post workout meal.

Q: "Thoughts on alcohol? Should I avoid altogether? Only certain days/times? Only certain types? (i.e. no beer, but spirits)."

A: Red wine is by far the best, but I would limit it to one glass, anything else, limit to a few times a week on rest days.

Q: "What are your thoughts on diet sodas?"

A: I would avoid caffeine filled ones as we don't want to become resistant to caffeine. For weight loss, won't matter, for health, avoid aspartame. Overall, I don't drink them, and I'm not a fan, but if you like them, try to limit them as much as possible.

Q: "Do I have to worry/concern myself about fats for my big solid meals? Should I try to have chicken breast instead of chicken thighs, for example?"

A: Try to avoid fatty foods around workout times, and try to avoid having them multiple days too often.

Q: "Hey, thanks for all that detailed info. I have a question regarding schedule: I can only workout in my morning period. I wake up at 8:30 and usually go gym around 10. So is there a way for morning gym goers to follow this plan?"

A: I had to do this for a few weeks once during a big poker series I wanted to play. For me, I found 2 ways that would work and picked the better of the two for me. First one is: take 5g's of the back 30 minutes before and 10g's after, then 10g's at noon. Here you will want to eat carbs, in a perfect world you would just want liquid dextrose. In reality, you will probably eat French fries or rice or Twinkies. On day's you're feeling it, do liquid carbs that are fast acting and fast absorbing. Low fiber/fat etc. Make sure to drink your water, 1 liter when you wake, 1 liter when you take back, 1 liter during a workout. This is no joke, this is the main reason people have problems is that they don't take the water part seriously. Then go about your normal eating such, if you're doing my plan, it would

be a liquid shake again after back and then a solid meal after that. Try to stop eating around 2 hours before you sleep, 4 hours on day's you're feeling it. This is long already, I will make a post about this going into what I did step by step and send it to you.

Q: "What are the rules of thumbs when it comes to working out in the morning and late evening as shown in my PT schedule? I am supposed to have a big meal around an hour after my workout (around 5:15 pm) but routine says morning should be fasting, and routinely says at night no food within 4 hours before bedtime. My big problem is, morning and night are when ALL my workout times are at. How can I take care of this?"

A: Yes, morning workouts are a bit trickier. Here is my advice on morning and night workouts:

AM workouts: 30 minutes prior, BCAA powder 5-7gs before working out.

BCAA 10g directly post workout.

BCAA 5g every hour on the hour until you break your fast 4-5 hours after. Breakfast with .25g of protein per lb of LBM and .5g per lb of fast acting carbs.

Have big solid meal 1-2 hours after this. Before you sleep, you will need to eat complex carbs like nuts or vegetables. We need these slow carbs to be there for us in the morning when we awake. Only do

this the nights before your workouts. If you're not working out the next day, don't eat anything 3-4 hours before sleeping.

PM workouts: Same as normal, except we're either having are big solid meal no less than an hour before or one hour after your workout. (PWO shake is always mandatory and always needs to be taken no more than 10-20 minutes after your workout.) Going anabolic at night is not a big deal, it's good in the sense that we give our bodies a rest from making HGH which will result in bigger HGH spurts later on. On off days just do the routine as normal.

Q: "What if you do your workouts at the end of the day (a few hours before bed)? Would I skip the carbs with my protein shake?"

A: No, you must have your PWO carbs. Then you might be referring to the HGH spike when you first sleep. Yes, you will suffer that loss of HGH at night, but the PWO carbs are far more important for raising your insulin and supplying the muscles with glycogen. In my new guide, I suggest always spiking your insulin the nights you work out (I explain why there) and not spiking it the nights you do not work out to get the best of both worlds.

Q: "Dan, can you explain a bit what you need to do before you start? You called it carb shocking. How many days? Food types? Macros?"

A: No need to count macros, just consciously eat more carbs for one week, have carbs with every meal. Protein can be anything over 75 grams this week each day.

Q: "So, basically around what hour in the evening should you stop eating and enter the fasting mode? And also, after you reach your target weight, how should the maintenance mode look like? I can't imagine feeding myself with shakes for my whole life."

A: You can eat right before you go to bed, as long as it's protein and not carbohydrates. Protein shakes are optimal, but you can replace with easy to digest protein like eggs, or chicken, or fish or soy proteins, as long as they too are low in carbohydrates.

Q: "How can I customize this plan if I work out until around 5:30-6 pm?"

A: Keep calories low until workout, then eat most of your calories afterward.

Q: "Does it matter/make a difference if we use whey or isolate protein? Is there one you recommend over the other?"

A: Either is fine. Isolate is quicker absorbing.

Q: Should I be taking both fish oil and chia seed, or is just one okay? You recommend no more than 40 calories so I would take a

little more than a half tablespoon of chia seed a day. Is this correct?

A: You can take both, you can actually have up to 60ish. I use 1 teaspoon of chia or 1 cap of fish oil (11cals) and lite cream in my coffee.

Q: What other dextrose powder foods would you recommend? (You listed Twinkies, cookies, and donuts)

A: Gatorade is good, not food but it's good PWO. Anything with fast acting carbs – rice is a healthy choice.

Q: I'm looking to burn fat, so a calorie deficit is necessary. I'm 6'3" and 240lbs -- how many calories should I be taking in a day given an hour walk in the morning and ~30mins of HIIT or another intense workout in the afternoon?

A: Follow my routine, and you will not have to count, first two meals liquid after not eating for 6 hours, PWO meal liquid, and solid big meal hour later and high protein low carb foods or shakes at night, chicken breast tuna, etc. I only count when I bulk. You will always be in a deficit with this routine if you just eat naturally. With that said I wouldn't go over 2500.

Q: Finally, you mention having a refeed day after 6 days of the routine. Is this a relax day, or do you continue with the early day fasting and protein shakes, exercise, and just have more carbs at the end of the day?

A: I go crazy, I wake up with cookies and ice cream. I eat whatever I want as much as I want. I don't fast on this day, to give

the body a rest from producing HGH at such a high level. Very high carb this day, I always wake up feeling ripped after this day.

Q: My main aim is to lose body fat percentage and then maximize gains. I consider myself at an intermediate level when it comes to lifting weights.

I wake up at around 8:30ish. I'm a 20-year-old, 160lbs male with around 20% body fat. So, here is the routine I made based on your answers:

8:30 AM – Drink around 800ml of water when I wake up and take some omega 3 capsules/chia seeds - Good

9:30 AM (one hour after waking up) – Drink another 800ml water plus a cup of coffee/tea. - Good

2:30 PM (6-7 hours after waking up) – Drink 25g protein shake (low carb) and one liter of water - Good

4:30 PM (2 hours after my first shake) – Drink another 25g protein shake (low carb), mixed with creatine and 7-12g BCAA powder - Good

5:30 PM (30 minutes to 1 hour after the second shake) – Workout and 1 liter of water - Good

Now in the exercise part, I'm planning to follow your workout plan given here. In this, you've given 3 rest days. My question is, what to do on the rest days? - Relax, recuperate. If you're cutting, you can throw an HIIT on Saturday every other week. Fasting morning walks are nice.

Moreover, when should I do the HIIT sessions? Before the lifting sessions, or on the resting days? - Once every other week on Saturday. You can experiment and try every week.

Right after my workout – A 50g protein shake with 100-150g carbs via Twinkies/cookies/donuts etc. - Good

8:30ish – Solid meal with around 40-50g protein - Perfect

And then, I usually go to bed at 12 AM, so I should take another meal having around 70g protein after the solid meal? - Yep

Step 10 in your guide is where I am confused. - Eat at least .5-1.5g of protein. At night we don't want to go high carbs because you most likely want them. So I just make my last meal pure protein (shake or chicken etc.).

Other concern, what can I eat before my fasted workouts to ease my hunger as eating something solid so late in the day will really make me want to throw up? - All liquid before your workout, if you really need something solid, make it smaller and easy to digest like eggs or peanut butter (low complex carb). I will only do this if you need to. All liquid protein before a workout is the optimal setup.

I've tried intermittent fasting (with fasted workouts) before and feel comfortable in not eating anything till 1-2PM. Anything late than that, I feel really hungry. - Most likely due to lack of water. When you fast, you don't become dehydrated quicker, but you feel every bump so to speak. Just up your water, when you feel even a little hungry, jug some water. 2 pm is late in the day, and it is fine to

have a protein shake before. You've read all 3 guides, you can mix and match. Like just BCAA before your workout is the best route, but that's hardcore and not even I can do that every day, so I switch based on how I feel. Your body will adapt, and you will be able to push your limits much further.

I really hope you help to clear my doubts about your plans. Hoping to hear from you soon. - Any other doubts or questions feel free to let me know!

Q: "How does a typical week look like when you are trying to implement IF? When are the high carb days/regular days and what days are IF?"

A: Follow the exact plan for 6 days a week with 1 day being your refeed day where you eat carbs in the morning and throughout the day. Lower carb days can be done on rest days, and normal to moderate carb days are done on workout days.

Cut Day

7 am Mouthwash / 2 cups of water right when waking / Drink two more until 8:30 am/ingest Omega three sources no more than 0-30 calories.

8 am: Coffee / Tea (light creme/milk if you prefer, no more than 30 calories) + Drink 1-2 liters of water for the duration until 1 am

1 pm: Whey protein 25-30 grams / 1-2 grams HMB / Caffeine or

pre-workout of your choice taken now,

1:45pm: Workout / Intense / 40 minutes – 1 hour

3pm: 40-50 grams Whey protein / 50-gram dextrose powder / 1 banana / 1 apple / 1 cup of green spinach leaves / 1-2 g MSM / 5g creatine / 1-2g stevia sweetener.

5 pm: 15 grams whey protein 10 grams BCAA powder.

7 pm: Large meal w/ lower carbs. (Complex carbs acceptable, no fast acting, no deserts.)

10 pm: 15-grams whey protein 10-gram BCAA

Rest Day

7 am Mouthwash / 2 cups of water right when waking / Drink two more until 8:30 am/ingest Omega three sources no more than 0-30 calories.

8 am: Coffee/Tea (light creme/milk if you prefer, no more than 30 calories) + Drink 1-2 liters of water for the duration until 1 am

3 pm: 1 Apple with 5 gram of BCAA powder and 1-2grams of HMB.

5 pm: 25-30 gram whey protein, 5g creatine

7 pm: Large meal, lower carbs, Complex carbs acceptable, no fast acting, no deserts.

10pm: 15-gram whey protein 10-gram BCAA / 1gram MSM

Rest Day

7 am Mouthwash / 2 cups of water right when waking / Drink two more until 8:30 am/ingest Omega three sources no more than 0-30

calories.

8 am: Coffee/Tea (light creme/milk if you prefer, no more than 30 calories) + Drink 1-2 liters of water for the duration until 1 am

3 pm: 1 Apple with 5 gram of BCAA powder and 1-2grams of HMB, lemon.

5 pm: 25-30 gram whey protein, 5g creatine any fruit or vegetable of your choice.

7 pm: Large meal, lower carbs, Complex carbs acceptable, no fast acting, no deserts.

10pm: 15-gram whey protein 10-gram BCAA / 1gram MSM / lemon.

Battle Day

7 am Mouthwash / 2 cups of water right when waking / Drink two more until 8:30 am/ingest Omega three sources no more than 0-30 calories.

8 am: Coffee/Tea (light creme/milk if you prefer, no more than 30 calories) + Drink 1-2 liters of water for the duration until 1 am

1 pm: Whey protein 25-30 grams / 1-2 grams HMB / Caffeine or pre-workout of your choice taken now,

1:45 pm: Workout, intense, 40 minutes – 1 hour

3pm: 40-50 grams Whey protein / 50-gram dextrose powder / 1 banana / 1 apple / 1 cup of green spinach leaves / 1-2 g MSM / 5g creatine / 1-2g stevia sweetener / 1 lemon

5 pm: 15 grams whey protein 10 grams BCAA powder.

7 pm: Large meal, lower carbs, Complex carbs acceptable, no fast acting, no deserts.

10 pm: 15-gram whey protein 10-gram BCAA

Rest Day

7 am Mouthwash / 2 cups of water right when waking / Drink two more until 8:30 am/ingest Omega three sources no more than 0-30 calories.

8 am: Coffee/Tea (light crème/milk if you prefer, no more than 30 calories) + Drink 1-2 liters of water for the duration until 1 am

3 pm: 1 Apple with 5 gram of BCAA powder and 1-2 grams of HMB.

5 pm: 25-30 gram whey protein, 5g creatine, any fruit or vegetable of your choice,

7 pm: Large meal, lower carbs, Complex carbs acceptable, no fast acting, no deserts.

10pm: 15-gram whey protein 10-gram BCAA / 1gram MSM

Refeed

7 am Mouthwash, 1 cup of water with lemon, 2g HMB, 2g nitric oxide booster, High carb easy to digest. Pancakes and syrup with coffee with sugar and crème.

9 am any meal with carbs and protein.

11 am: Protein shakes with peanut butter, banana, and apple

3 pm: Any meal with carbs and protein, preferably lower,

generous 2 cups of water with lemon.

8 pm: huge meal whatever I want, burger and fries, etc. with desert

11 pm: more desert.

Final Thoughts

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This book is here to help you to lose the body fat, but if you want to keep it off, you have to lose the brain fat too. I never give weight loss advice until I know the person is mentally ready. With that being said, this is a basic guideline that will help get you on the right path. The first few days will be brutal, you must be strongly built, like a shed in the wind. Learn to stand firm but have a little give in you. You cannot be so rigid when you are attempting this. Some days you may fail miserably. That is no reason to throw your hands up and quit. This can be a good thing because it keeps the body out of balance. When the body is out of balance it cannot guess your next move. Example, one day you are fasting and below caloric deficit, but the next day you eat a donut right when you wake up and go over caloric maintenance; that just means when you cut the next day the fat will pour off of you. I hope you can see that losing weight is not some excruciating task that takes all your will power you can lose 100 pounds eating donuts and calzones like me and so many of my clients. If you're not enjoying it, you're doing it wrong. Losing the weight in a manner which is pleasing is what it's all about. How do you expect to stay lean when you lost the weight doing something you hate? This is a long haul, end game thinking.

I'm not here to convert anyone to delaying breakfast; I'm only spreading what I know to be right in the least biased way. Believe

me; I would love to hear I'm wrong and that breakfast in the morning consistently is good for you! That would be nice. Instead of water I would have bacon and eggs with some buttered toast and an apple! Until someone can lay the facts out for me as I have for them, I'm simply 100% unconvinced. I talk to these people, and they defend it so vigorously like it's their job. I realized, it IS their job. It's their job to be right in their minds, it's hard to accept being wrong for most of your life, teaching your kids the wrong way hurts even more. The worst thing is to be wrong most of your life, learn the right way, but refuse to grow and learn.

Let's not build up walls to protect our egos, let's help change this world. One in three people are considered obese with heart failure, depression, and stress being the top killers in our world; taking so many we love before their time. These major three killers are directly influenced by our weight and how we feel when we look in the mirror.

I wanted to make money because I thought it would make me a happier person, I found out that was not the case. I wanted to ensure I wasn't losing the weight for outside approval. I knew that would lead me to an empty spot later in life. When I was very poor all I wanted was to make money. I thought this would lead to happiness. And when I made money, I remember I would have these feelings towards friends of mine who were broke and didn't work as hard as me. I let my ego become indirectly attacked when I saw someone who wasn't

working as hard as me and had less. This was because deep down I was actually jealous, jealous that someone could be happy in a situation I could not be. My ability to not be happy in my present moment automatically creates this ego mind within. The ego mind will start to judge those based on how our life has gone. I wasn't happy when I didn't have a lot of money, therefore when I raised my level of income and saw someone enjoying their lives with less than what I had, and worked less than I did, I would judge them. The ego is very determined and doesn't like being threatened. This ego mind that I let live in me for years put me on a pedestal above everyone who wasn't doing the same as me.

When I let my ego mind die, I immediately started to see other people's ego minds. When being present more often, judgment fades and my ability to see clearer happened. I started to see that people's most deep-seated fears comes out. Some people believe all that is needed is to lose weight to be happy and gain acceptance. Getting the compliments and praise boosts these people's hollow ego with a false sense of confidence. Even when these types of people achieve the body desired, still deep down is a lingering feeling this uncertainty, this lack of acceptance.

A million people can love you, but you must love yourself first. If you don't love yourself first you're going to feel in your heart of hearts, unaccepted, and overall not good enough. On the other hand, if a million people hate you, but you, in your heart of hearts, love

yourself fully and are fully self-aware, then you'll always feel accepted. It starts with you.

The seed you plant will dictate the outcome every time. If you plant a weed, it's going to be a weed. If you plant a rose, it's going to be a rose. No matter how you take care of the plant, the seed is what dictates what grows. The real issue is, people who lose weight for outside acceptance, then they receive the acceptance, the love, and praise, they then need this; they feel trapped by this. Because if you didn't lose the weight for the love of working out, and the process of sculpting your body, you'd get to a place where you'll have to continue doing something you don't love just to receive the false love you feel is needed. We only judge ourselves in an indirect manner, giving ourselves permission to feel the way we do.

Doing something for outside approval will only lead to you being left out in the rain one day. The seasons and weather always change, and if you position yourself based on the approval of others, it will lead you down a path of a hollow life, and you'll find yourself on a foundation built on something you don't love. You'll ultimately become trapped and depressed and defensive and judgmental of others who aren't exactly like you.

Once you can learn to love yourself, you can value the time you have left. Right now is the most thrilling time of your life! Once you get ripped, you're there. You've made it. It's great, but it has the purple cow effect. If you drive by and see a normal cow, you're

going to keep driving. If you drive by and see a purple cow, you're going to stop, and take pictures. If you drive by 100 more purple cows, they become, just another cow. No big deal. This is life, we must appreciate every cow, white or purple. Think of it like a cake. What's the most enjoyable part of the cake? Eating it! Yet we still rush to devour it, to finish it. Once you've eaten the cake, it's done, you're satisfied. You've fulfilled the cake eating mission. I enjoyed the process and seeing the progress. Getting the reactions from friends and family. Once you've become ripped, the gains are fewer, the upgrades further in between. I wanted to savor the moments, the progress was special to me.

When I'm giving people life advice, I like to get them thinking. "What do you really want?" I often refer to seemingly pointless events that happen in our everyday lives that can provoke life-changing philosophies. These can instantly change our perspectives that will drastically change our lives.

Here's an example from the other day: My girlfriend's sister has an awesome young boy. So curious! He always wants to get into my girlfriend's purse while we're there. Usually, he's unsuccessful. He gets so upset! One day, my girlfriend simply let him have at it. He was shocked, he kept grabbing the purse, and looking back. To his surprise, he wasn't getting told, "NO!" Once he realized what was going on, he quickly grabbed the purse in victory and ran to the couch to discover his new found treasures, after all, this is all he really

wanted. There was magic in his eyes as he pulled out the contents of the bag. It wasn't long until all the content was pulled out and organized by color. I slowly saw his amazement turn to boredom. He eventually left the purse alone out of sheer boredom and now had his eyes fixated on the shiny jacket on the back of the chair. I thought to myself, wow, what a powerful analogy! How many of us want something so bad? We're so sure that's all we need to be happy. But once we get it, we get bored and want something else. It's a never ending loop of wanting stuff we "can't" have. I say this so you can find self-love at this very moment. Realize no matter what, you're already a success.

"There is nothing outside of yourself that can ever enable you to get better, stronger, richer, quicker, or smarter. Everything is within. Everything exists. Seek nothing outside of yourself." — Miyamoto Musashi

XFORMATION

With no destination in mind, a walk in a spring rain shower brought a moment of clarity. Having transformed my body through weight loss and exercise, I still did not find all of the answers I sought. With a 100 pound reduction and a body builder's physique, my family and friends showered me with compliments and praise, and for a while, I was completely satisfied with my achievement. Then, the doubts crept back into my thoughts: "Is this all there is?", "Have I reached all my goals"...if so, why do I feel this nagging uncertainty about my life? The rain cleared and there was my clarity. I remembered the dead tree stump, with its new bright green sprout growing out of it. Out of the old life, a new life emerged. Same as with me... my life is always evolving into a new and better one. I keep the wisdom from the old life and move into my future.

About the Author

Dan set out to change EVERYTHING! Losing 100 pounds while weight training got him to 8% body fat. Through trial and error, Dan approached his transformation tossing conventional rules and conventional thought aside. All the while, Dan accepted and revised thousands of routines from those who were following his progress, hoping for similar success. So satisfying was this effort, he now helps thousands change

"This book teaches you cutting-edge intermittent fasting techniques unlike any you have seen before. With five plans total, a Q&A section, on top of countless examples, this book hand delivers everything one could ever need to lose weight with intermittent fasting."